

ANTI-SMOG: GOV TO IMPOSE
42-DAY CONSTRUCTION BAN **P3**



'POLITICAL STABILITY MAKES
INDIA A BRIGHT SPOT' **P5**

TAAPSEE PANNU'S 'GANDHARI' TO
RELEASE ON SEPTEMBER 3 **P12**



HE CALLED FOR CLOSE MONITORING OF INFLUENZA TRENDS

Nearly 1,700 H1N1 cases in Delhi; Nadda reviews preparedness

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 21

As cases of H1N1 influenza increase in the national Capital with nearly 1,700 cases recorded this season so far, Union Health Minister J P Nadda reviewed the situation and preparedness measures on Friday. Nadda reviewed the national influenza surveillance and epidemiological situation, trends in influenza-like illness (ILI) and severe acute respiratory infections (SARI), testing and laboratory surveillance, and the preparedness of healthcare facilities, focusing particularly on Delhi, according to a statement by the Health Ministry. Delhi Health Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh also attended the meeting. "The Health Minister emphasised the need for close monitoring of influenza trends and proactive preparedness to ensure early detection and timely clinical management of cases," the statement said. Doctors in the city said hospitals have seen a spurt in



Union Health Minister JP Nadda reviews H1N1 influenza preparedness during a meeting, in New Delhi

KEY POINTS

- » Influenza-like illness and severe respiratory infection trends were assessed
- » Testing & laboratory surveillance systems were also reviewed

- » Healthcare preparedness received particular attention, especially in Delhi
- » Doctors reported a sharp rise in H1N1 cases recently
- » Healthy people generally reported mild symptoms, doctors said

COMMON SYMPTOMS INCLUDE SORE THROAT, CHEST PAIN AND RUNNY NOSE

H1N1 cases over the past couple of weeks. Many doctors cautioned that the virus was spreading fast, but symptoms in healthy people were mild—sore throat, chest pain, runny

nose. However, elderly people with pre-existing medical conditions were reporting serious symptoms. The preparedness of healthcare facilities in Delhi was also reviewed, including the availability of hospital beds, critical care facilities, and other essential supplies required to manage patients with seasonal influenza and severe respiratory illness. Nadda stressed the importance of public awareness and adherence to preventive health practices, including respiratory and hand hygiene. "People experiencing persistent or severe respiratory symptoms, breathing difficulty or other warning signs should seek medical advice promptly," the minister said. The Health Ministry said the situation is being closely and continuously monitored and that it is coordinating with states and Union Territories, hospitals, laboratories and other stakeholders to strengthen surveillance and preparedness. **CONTINUED ON P4**

FIR filed in pellet gun case after Rahul's sit-in at police station



AAISHA SABIR
New Delhi, August 21

The Delhi Police on Friday registered an FIR in the case of a 19-year-old student protester who suffered pellet-gun injuries during the July 20 march to Parliament as Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi, accompanied by the victim, Sahil Lochab, staged a sit-in outside a Delhi police station. Gandhi refused to budge until an FIR was filed in the case. "I will sit on dharna outside police station for 30 days or even six months if

KEY POINTS

- » Delhi Police registered an FIR Friday over Sahil Lochab's pellet injuries
- » The 19-year-old student was injured during the July 20 Parliament march
- » Rahul Gandhi staged a sit-in outside a Delhi police station
- » Gandhi refused to leave until police registered the FIR

you don't register an FIR," Rahul Gandhi who sat on a day-long dharna, told the police personnel. **CONTINUED ON P4**

REACTION TO GOR'S J&K REMARKS

No reason to comment on Pak's frustration: MEA

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 21

India on Friday dismissed Pakistan's objection to remarks by US Ambassador to India Sergio Gorrilla that Jammu and Kashmir is an integral part of the country, saying it saw no reason to comment on Islamabad's reaction. "I see no reason to comment on Pakistan's frustration," External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said at a media briefing. Gor, who is also US President Donald Trump's Special Envoy to South and Central Asia, made the comments during his visit to Jammu and Kashmir on Wednesday. He described the Union territory as an important part of India. Pakistan's Foreign Office responded by summoning the US Charge d'Affaires in Islamabad and lodging a "strong demarche" over Gor's remarks. In a statement, it said Pakistan "strongly condemned and categorically rejected" the description of Jammu and Kashmir as a "part of India". Jaiswal said India's position remained unchanged, asserting that the Union **CONTINUED ON P4**

Briefs

'No ethanol link to sugar price spike'

NEW DELHI: The Centre on Friday rejected claims that diversion of sugar for ethanol production was behind the recent rise in sugar prices, saying the country has enough stocks to meet domestic demand. Food Secretary Sanjeev Chopra said the sharp increase was "unjustified" and urged the industry not to create artificial scarcity. **CONTINUED ON P4**

'Myanmar military strike kills 14 people'

BANGKOK: An air-strike on Friday by Myanmar's military on a Buddhist monastery in Myanmar's central Sagaing region killed 14 people who were taking part in a weeklong meditation retreat, an opposition group and a resident said. **SEE P8**

'Programme was not appropriate': Govt denies nod to Reddy's US trip

Think beyond 'politics and elections': Telangana CM

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE
New Delhi/Hyderabad, August 21

Telangana Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy has cancelled his planned visit to the United States after the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) declined to grant political clearance, saying the proposed programme was not appropriate for the office he holds. MEA spokesperson



A Revanth Reddy
Randhir Jaiswal said on Friday that the ministry reviews overseas visits by chief ministers and other dignitaries before granting political clearance. "The

programme proposed in such cases should be appropriate to the office held and the purpose of the visit. In this particular case, that was not so in respect of the US," he said at the ministry's bi-weekly media briefing. "Therefore, clearance has not been given. Incidentally, his visit to the UK has been cleared," Jaiswal added. **CONTINUED ON P4**

RESCUE OPS



Rescue personnel rescue local residents from a waterlogged area following rainfall, in Guwahati

Uncertainty continues over Bangladesh PM Rahman's visit to India

New Delhi, August 21

India and Bangladesh are holding back-channel talks to finalise Bangladesh Prime Minister Tarique Rahman's proposed New Delhi visit. His planned August 23-24 trip was delayed over unresolved issues. MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal offered no update. The talks follow tensions over Sheikh Hasina, while officials continue discussions on bilateral cooperation and the 1996 Ganga Water Treaty. **SEE P5**

DELIVERS 2:1 VERDICT

SC relaxes 3-year mandatory law practice norm to 1 year for entry level judicial exam

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 21

The Supreme Court on Friday relaxed the eligibility rules for law graduates seeking to enter the lower judiciary, reducing the effective mandatory practice requirement from three years to one year. The decision came in a 2:1 majority verdict delivered by a bench headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant and comprising Justices A G Masih and

TAKEAWAYS

- » CJI Surya Kant and Justice A G Masih form majority in Friday's verdict
- » Justice K Vinod Chandran dissents and dismisses the review petitions
- » May 2025 ruling had barred fresh graduates from entry-level judicial examinations



» Earlier ruling required candidates to complete three years of legal practice

K Vinod Chandran. The court, however, introduced a structured

training and clerkship programme for candidates selected under the

revised arrangement. They will be designated as "Trainee Judicial Officers" and will have to complete one year of intensive training at the concerned state judicial academy, followed by a further one-year law clerkship. The ruling modifies the Supreme Court's May 20, 2025 judgment, delivered by a bench headed by then Chief Justice of India B R Gavai, who has since retired. That judgment had barred fresh **CONTINUED ON P4**

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MPD-2047 plan puts edu, clean energy on priority list

MINISTER ASHISH SOOD SETS OUT PRIORITIES AS DELHI BEGINS 2047 PLAN ROLLOUT

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, August 21

Delhi’s education sector, energy infrastructure and clean economy will be among the key focus areas as the government begins implementing the Master Plan for Delhi-2047 (MPD-2047), Urban Development Minister Ashish Sood told *Millennium Post* on Friday. Outlining priorities in the sectors under his charge, Sood said the government would simultaneously push reforms in education, power and urban development while seeking public participation in implementing the ambitious roadmap.

Education: Narela hub, private universities and safer coaching ecosystem

Calling education one of the biggest pillars of the new Master Plan, Sood said the government wants Delhi to emerge as a destination for higher education instead of allowing institutions to move elsewhere.

“Our objective is that Delhi’s education industry should not move out of the city. We want to create opportunities here itself,” Sood shared.

He said 138 hectares of land in Narela have been reserved for educational development, where universities, research institutions, vocational training centres and innovation ecosystems will come up. The minister added that the government is also exploring ways to facilitate private universities, including utilisation of land in low-density areas.

“The Master Plan also proposes increased Floor Area Ratio (FAR) for schools, standalone schools for children with disabilities, residential schools and expansion of institutional hubs,” he asserted. A major reform allows coaching and vocational training centres to operate from school campuses after school hours.

Explaining the move, Sood said, “Many coach-



ing centres are currently operating from unsuitable buildings where safety concerns, including fire hazards, often arise. Allowing coaching and vocational classes to function in school campuses after school hours will provide better infrastructure and a safer environment for students. The provision will apply to both government and private schools.”

Power: Renewable energy and cheaper gas

On the energy front, Sood said the government will work on reducing energy costs while increasing the share of renewable power.

“We will work towards ensuring cheaper gas and increasing the use of renewable energy. We will also renew power purchase agreements wher-

“WE WILL WORK TOWARDS ENSURING CHEAPER GAS AND INCREASING THE USE OF RENEWABLE ENERGY. WE WILL ALSO RENEW POWER PURCHASE AGREEMENTS WHEREVER REQUIRED — ASHISH SOOD

ever required. If we are able to generate more power through our own turbines, electricity will become more affordable. For all these measures, we will work closely with the Central government,” he said.

The Master Plan estimates Delhi’s peak power demand will rise to 25,500 MW by 2047 and proposes a Renewable Energy Plan to identify future projects.

Among the proposals are solar farms under the Agriculture-cum-Solar Farm Scheme, utilisation

of canals and drains for solar and hydro projects, rooftop solar installations on government buildings larger than 500 square metres, renewable energy adoption at airports, Metro stations, railway stations, bus depots and stadiums, solar-powered LED lighting, smart meters, underground power lines and modern substations.

The plan also proposes expanding piped natural gas by integrating gas pipelines along roads wider than 12 metres, promoting PNG in new developments and extending the network to regenerating unauthorised colonies.

Implementation to move on all fronts

When asked about the implementation roadmap and priority projects, Sood said the government does not intend to sequence the Master Plan sector-wise.

“There will certainly be challenges, but our responsibility is to find solutions. People have placed their

trust in us and we cannot let them down. Every project under MPD-2047 is a priority, and work across different departments will begin simultaneously,” he said.

He also stressed that public participation would be critical for the successful implementation of the Master Plan.

Economic growth and inclusive development

MPD-2047 shifts Delhi’s planning approach from regulation to development, aiming to make the capital a green, climate-resilient and globally competitive city while creating jobs and attracting investment.

It proposes investment-ready commercial districts, innovation and research ecosystems, economic hubs focused on IT, cyber economy, healthcare, education, logistics, MICE, tourism, media and circular economy, along with redevelopment of existing commercial centres, mixed-use transit-oriented

development, decentralised workspaces, co-working spaces, warehouses and a 24x7 economy.

The plan also focuses on youth, women, children, senior citizens and persons with disabilities by proposing libraries, community centres, sports facilities, innovation hubs, pedestrian-friendly public spaces and better neighbourhood infrastructure.

Among other key proposals highlighted by Sood were commercial activity on the ground floors of properties along 30-metre-wide roads, redevelopment of planned and unauthorised colonies through resident consensus, Transit-Oriented Development around Metro stations, in-situ rehabilitation of JJ clusters, simplified land pooling, expansion of green spaces, zero-waste campuses, long-term water augmentation projects and strengthening Delhi’s power infrastructure for future demand.

CCTV watch on biometric devices after tampering

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 21

The Delhi government will install CCTV cameras to monitor biometric attendance devices in district offices, institutions and the headquarters of the Social Welfare Department after inspections indicated suspected deliberate tampering with several machines. The move comes after

repeated complaints of malfunctioning biometric devices. During inspections, service engineers found water inside multiple attendance machines despite there being no nearby water source or plumbing, raising suspicion that some devices had been intentionally damaged. Officials said similar findings were reported from several offices.



The department has directed that CCTV surveillance be introduced to prevent further damage and

ensure proper functioning of the attendance system.

Officials also acknowledged that employees in departments such as Social Welfare, Women and Child Development and Labour often perform field duties, making it difficult to mark attendance through office-based biometric devices. To address this, the department is exploring a mobile-based Aadhaar-enabled

biometric attendance system integrated with facial recognition and real-time geolocation for field staff. The IT Branch has been asked to examine its technical feasibility. Biometric attendance was made mandatory across Delhi government departments earlier this year, with officials required to record attendance at the beginning and end of the workday.

106 INDUSTRIAL UNITS FACE ACTION

Anti-smog: Gov to impose 42-day construction ban

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, August 21

The Delhi government is stepping up its winter anti-pollution drive, announcing a 42-day blanket ban on construction activities from December 10 to January 20 while taking action against industrial units violating environmental norms. The government said 106 of the 2,011 industrial units inspected between January and July were found non-compliant with environmental standards, with compensation imposed on 44 units and closure orders issued against 33.

“Construction will be completely banned from December 10 to January 20. If you spot any violation, inform MCD, your MLA, or me directly,” Gupta said.

She said construction had continued at some sites last winter despite GRAP restrictions. “Last time, even under GRAP, some construction continued behind covers,” she said.

This winter, construction sites measuring over 500 square metres will be monitored through the



Delhi government’s Dust Portal 2.0 and AI-enabled cameras. Alerts will reach the Control and Command Centre, following which notices, warnings and fines will be issued.

Launched in July, Dust Portal 2.0 uses GIS mapping, 360-degree PTZ cameras, PM10 and PM2.5 sensors and AI-based analytics to track construction and demolition sites. It also offers district-wise pollution dashboards, hotspot analysis and digital enforcement notices.

The government has simultaneously stepped up action against industrial

pollution. Between January and July 2026, 2,011 industrial units were inspected, with 106 found non-compliant with environmental norms. Of these, 78 were operating without a valid Consent to Operate (CTO) from the Delhi Pollution Control Committee.

Gupta said the government’s objective is to control pollution at its source rather than merely penalise offenders. “Our objective is not merely to take action, but to ensure effective control over pollution at its source,” she said.

She added, “Industries that comply with environmental regulations will receive support and facilitation, but strict action will continue against those that pollute Delhi’s air.”

The anti-pollution drive also covers road dust, vehicular emissions, waste burning and illegal dumping. Gupta urged citizens to report violations through the Green Delhi App or MCD 311 App, stressing that public participation is essential in identifying polluters and ensuring timely action.

Delhi: Polling stations likely to rise after SIR rationalisation

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 21

The number of polling stations in Delhi are likely to increase after rationalisation is carried out as part of the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

Officials said new stations will be created wherever the number of electors exceeds the prescribed limit of 1,200, down from the earlier limit of 1,500.

A senior official of the Delhi Chief Electoral Officer’s office on Friday said that, according to the pre-SIR data, there are some polling stations where the number of electors is more than 1,200.

“The district election officers have sent proposals for revision and, once these are approved, voters will have to be tagged to the newly created polling stations in the IT system,” the official said.

Delhi currently has 13,033 polling stations, also referred to as polling booths or parts, spread across about 3,000 polling locations in 13 districts. A location, such as a school, can house four to five polling stations. Under the rationalisation exercise, additional polling stations will be created wherever the number of electors exceeds 1,200, with the number of additional stations depending on the voter count. The new stations or locations will be kept within a two-kilometre radius of the existing polling station, officials said.

MCD launches special ‘mosquito-control train’

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 21

The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) on Friday launched a special anti-mosquito drive to cover around 75 km of railway tracks and adjoining areas in the capital, targeting waterlogged spots and other potential breeding sites during monsoon.

According to an official statement, Mayor Praveesh Wahi flagged off the ‘Mosquito Terminator Train-2026’ (MTT-2026) from New Delhi Railway Station as part of the joint vector-control initiative of the MCD and Northern Railway.

The campaign will

involve anti-larvae treatment of low-lying and waterlogged areas along railway tracks, with power spray tankers deployed to reach locations that are difficult to access manually, the civic body said. “During the monsoon, accumulation of water around railway tracks and in low-lying areas increases the possibility of mosquito breeding. The key objective is to break the mosquito breeding cycle at its initial stage,” the statement said quoting Wahi. The campaign is scheduled to continue till September, with zonal health teams and Northern Railway coordinating the anti-larvae operations.

Patient’s attendants attack GTB hosp docs

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 21

Attendants of a road accident victim allegedly attacked doctors and other staff and damaged hospital property at the newly shifted emergency facility of Delhi’s Guru Teg Bahadur Hospital in Tahirpur, according to a statement.

The incident took place in the early hours of Thursday when the condition of the patient, Pawan, deteriorated while he was being treated at the emergency facility, which has been moved to Rajiv Gandhi Super Speciality Hospital (RGSSH). The patient was referred from Lok Nayak

Hospital on August 19 with an internal brain injury following a road accident, it said. As the patient was being resuscitated, his attendants allegedly gathered and created a ruckus, during which they damaged hospital property and smashed window panes.

The hospital in the statement alleged that the attendants intimidated and threatened doctors, nurses and other staff and attacked them with broken glass and knives, besides allegedly carrying a pistol. Police personnel were also present at the time of the incident.

No comments were available from the patient’s end.

RAIN FORECAST OVER WEEKEND Delhi crosses Aug rain mark

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 21

Delhi has surpassed its normal August rainfall, with the Safdarjung observatory recording 235.3 mm in the first 21 days of the month, as more rain is expected over the weekend.

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) initially reported that Delhi had crossed its average August rainfall of 233.1 mm earlier in the month. The figures were later revised for a specific date following an entry error, and the city was found to be below the monthly normal at that point.

Delhi recorded a maximum temperature of 35.8 degrees Celsius on Thursday, 1.6 degrees above normal.

Station-wise, Palam recorded 34.7 degrees Celsius, 0.2 degrees above normal, while Lodhi Road recorded 36.1 degrees Celsius, 3.1 degrees above normal. Ridge recorded



35.0 degrees Celsius, 1.1 degrees above normal, and Ayanagar recorded 35.7 degrees Celsius, 1.6 degrees above normal.

The IMD forecast generally cloudy skies with light rain or drizzle during the day on Friday. Very light to light rainfall is likely during the night, while moderate rain is expected on Saturday.

The minimum temperature in Delhi on Friday settled at 28.4 degrees Celsius, 1.9 degrees above

normal. Palam recorded a minimum of 25.6 degrees Celsius, 0.7 degrees below normal, while Lodhi Road recorded 27.8 degrees Celsius, 1.8 degrees above normal.

The minimum temperature at Ridge was 25.2 degrees Celsius, 0.1 degrees above normal, while Ayanagar recorded 27.3 degrees Celsius, 1.7 degrees above normal.

The relative humidity was 60 per cent in the morning.

MPD-2047 plan clears six key deregulation hurdles, says L-G

Phase-I focuses on zoning and building approvals

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, August 21

With the Master Plan for Delhi-2047 (MPD-2047) now notified, six key Priority Areas under Phase-I of Delhi’s Deregulation and Compliance Reduction exercise relating to flexible zoning norms, building regulations and approvals have substantially been addressed, Lieutenant Governor Sardar T. S. Sandhu said on Friday.

L-G directed departments to ensure that all pending reforms are implemented on priority by the end of this month. The six reforms covered areas including flexible zoning norms, minimum road width for industries in rural areas, building regulations for industrial and commercial plots, the role of empanelled third

CLOSER LOOK

» L-G directed departments to ensure that all pending reforms are implemented on priority by the end of this month

» The six reforms covered areas including flexible zoning norms, minimum road width for industries in rural areas, building regulations for industrial and commercial plots, the role of empanelled third parties in building approvals and third party inspections for low and medium risk buildings

parties in building approvals and third party inspections for low and medium risk buildings. The notification of MPD 2047 has enabled the implementation of these remaining Phase-I Priority Areas. Of the 23 Priority Areas under Phase-I, 13 have been implemented, while four were considered not applicable following the enactment of the new Labour Codes. The TOD Policy and its regulations, notified on April

6, 2026, are already under implementation. The Urban Development Department is also set to notify the urbanisation of Delhi’s remaining 48 villages, while proposed amendments to the Unified Building Bye Laws, 2016, are awaiting final notification.

On Phase-II, seven Priority Areas had been implemented as of August 20, including the removal of dual trade licences by MCD, perpetual registration for

shops and commercial establishments, and electricity connections up to 200 KW without inspection. Two more reforms have been recommended as implemented, while 18 are at advanced stages. The meeting was also informed that the Delhi Ease of Doing Business Bill, 2026, has been redrafted and will be placed before the Cabinet. The Delhi Right of Citizen to Time Bound Delivery of Services Bill, 2026, has been passed by the Legislative Assembly, with final notification under process.

The Tourism Department has notified the repeal of the Bed and Breakfast Establishments Act, 2007, while a new BnB Policy is in its final stages. DGHS has been appointed as the Single Nodal Agency for healthcare related licences.

FROM SCHOOL INSPECTION TO COURTROOM

CJP alleges attack on Ranka; Saurav Das moves Delhi HC

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, August 21

A visit to highlight the poor condition of a government school in Jaipur ended with an alleged assault on Cockroach Janta Party co-convenor Ashutosh Ranka, while the party's spokesperson Saurav Das turned to the Delhi High Court over the alleged public disclosure of his home address.

Ranka and party volunteers were attacked near Rampura Kanwar-pura village in Jaipur's Bagru assembly constituency while on their way to inspect a government school. Ranka alleged that the attackers were associated with the ruling BJP. One CJP volunteer reportedly suffered a fractured arm.

A video purportedly showing the confrontation has surfaced, in which a group of people can be seen surrounding the CJP team while slogans of "Jai Shri Ram" are heard. The party said its team intended to examine the school's infrastructure, classrooms and facilities available to students.

Ranka had earlier raised concerns over the condition of the school, alleging that portions of its main building had deteriorated and students were being taught in a temporary shed. He claimed the struc-



A damaged car is seen during CJP's 'School Thik Karo' campaign, in Jaipur PTI

INSIGHT

- » Ranka alleged that the attackers were associated with the ruling BJP. One CJP volunteer reportedly suffered a fractured arm
- » Das approached the Delhi HC against commentator Abhijit Iyer Mitra, X, Google and several law portals and media platforms for making his personal details public

ture was being supported with iron angles and that even animal fodder was lying inside the shed.

The alleged attack came days after CJP members visited a government school in Thanagazi, Alwar, and protested over its condition. Following that episode, Rajasthan's Secondary Education Department issued directions requiring outsiders to obtain written permission before entering gov-

ernment schools. The rules also regulate photography, videography and interviews involving students.

Despite the restrictions, Ranka said CJP would continue visiting government schools to highlight issues affecting students. CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke also condemned the alleged assault and accused BJP workers of being behind it.

Meanwhile, CJP spokesperson Saurav Das

approached the Delhi High Court on Friday against commentator Abhijit Iyer Mitra, X, Google and several law portals and media platforms. Das alleged that his residential address and other personal details had been repeatedly published online, creating a serious threat to his privacy and safety.

He sought injunctions preventing further disclosure and directions to remove the allegedly offending posts and videos.

He also alleged that footage of the interiors of his shared residential premises had been recorded and circulated.

Das has sought protection of his privacy, dignity and security, along with damages for the alleged violation of his rights.

TRIAL IN ABSENTIA FOR 26/11 ATTACKS

Cops seek MHA help to serve order against Hafiz & 5 others

MPOST BUREAU

Mumbai, August 21

The Mumbai Police have approached the Union Home Ministry to serve the court proclamation orders via Interpol against six absconding accused, including Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) founders Hafiz Saeed and Zaki-ur-Rehman Lakhvi, setting the stage to try them in absentia for their role in the 26/11 terror attacks.

The police, represented by special public prosecutor Ujjwal Nikam, submitted on Friday an interim report on the proclamation order issued in July this year against the absconding accused for initiating the process for trial in absentia.

"We have written to the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) for taking necessary steps in serving the proclamation order, through Interpol, against the accused residing in Pakistan," Nikam told the special court hearing terror cases.

"On August 3, the MHA had acknowledged our request, and sought time for filing a status of the same," he said.

Section 356 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), 2023, mandates full criminal trials in absentia for proclaimed offenders, who have absconded to evade trial and where



HIGHLIGHTS

- » The police, represented by special public prosecutor Ujjwal Nikam, submitted on Friday an interim report on the proclamation order issued in July this year against the absconding accused for initiating the process for trial in absentia
- » The role of these men in the attack was mentioned by terrorist Ajmal Kasab and accused turned approver David Headley
- » A total of 166 people, including six Americans, were killed in the 2008 Mumbai terror attacks in which 10 Pakistani terrorists laid a more than 60-hour siege

there is no immediate prospect of arrest.

The court conducting trial in the 26/11 attacks case had issued the proclamation orders against Saeed, Lakhvi and other absconding accused Sajid Mir, Abu Alqama, Asim alias Abu Qahafa, and Major Abdur Rehman Pasha, all Pakistani nationals.

The role of these men in the attack was mentioned by terrorist Ajmal Kasab and accused turned approver David Headley.

Kasab was the lone surviving Pakistani terror-

ist captured alive during the 26/11 Mumbai attacks in November 2008. Convicted of mass murder and waging war against India, he was sentenced to death and hanged at Yerwada Central Jail in Pune on November 21, 2012.

A total of 166 people, including six Americans, were killed in the 2008 Mumbai terror attacks in which 10 Pakistani terrorists laid a more than 60-hour siege, attacking people at iconic and vital locations of Mumbai.

Top Court comes to 'rescue' of 105-year-old murder convict

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, August 21

A 105-year old murder convict will now be able to live as a free man after the Supreme Court on Friday closed the case against him and waived the remaining period of his life sentence, taking into account his age.

Born in 1920 in West Bengal's Malda district, Rasik Chandra Mondal was convicted in 1994 in the murder case and was in jail till November 29, 2024, when the top court granted him bail.

On Friday, a bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana said that, having regard to the age of the petitioner, it was closing the case and waiving the remaining sentence, if any, in the matter.

Even if the life sentence is not over, he will not be taken back in custody, the CJI said and made the interim bail order of 2024 absolute and final.

Mondal had age-related health issues, it had noted.

In 2018, the Calcutta High Court dismissed Mondal's appeal challenging his conviction in the murder case. Later, he moved the apex court, which also dismissed his plea. In 2020, Mondal, then 99 years old, moved a plea seeking premature release, citing his advanced age and age-related ailments.

From page 1

Nearly 1,700

"The coordination is aimed at ensuring effective surveillance, early detection, timely clinical management and proactive preparedness for seasonal influenza, including H1N1," the statement said.

Nadda called for continued strengthening of early detection, timely testing and appropriate clinical management of influenza cases, along with effective utilisation of the existing surveillance and laboratory network.

On July 10, the Union Health Secretary wrote to all states and Union Territories, advising them to strengthen preparedness and surveillance for acute respiratory illness (ARI) and ensure that healthcare facilities remained adequately prepared.

The Union Health Minister reiterated that the situation was being closely and continuously monitored and stressed the need for sustained and coordinated efforts for prevention and control of seasonal diseases, including dengue and malaria.

He called for a proactive and preparedness-orientated approach by state governments, with active participation of municipal councillors and other local bodies in generating awareness among communities about the prevention, spread and control of seasonal diseases.

Highlighting the increase in TB detection in the national capital through active involvement of local bodies and a whole-of-government approach, Nadda stressed the importance of public representatives at all levels disseminating factual and evidence-based information and strengthening community engagement.

FIR filed

The police collected the medical report and other related documents and the FIR has been filed against unknown persons based on the complaint given by the victim, police said.

"This is the first step towards justice. An FIR has been registered. Look at how long it took. It has been a month since the pellets were fired. There are pellets lodged in his (Sahil Loch-

ab's) body, three in his eye. It is clear that injustice has been done to a young person," the Congress leader said.

Gandhi told the media that the FIR represented the "first step towards justice" for the youth, who continues to carry over 200 pellets in his body, including three lodged in one eye that have impaired his vision.

He questioned why police took nearly eight hours to register the case, noting that the delay raised serious concerns about access to justice for ordinary citizens. "If justice is not available at a police station in the middle of Delhi, imagine what happens in villages and small towns," he remarked.

Gandhi, accompanied by his sister and MP Congress general secretary Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, student Lochab, his mother, and other party leaders, arrived at the police station around 11 am demanding FIR registration. Police finally registered the case at around 6:45 pm. Gandhi alleged that permission for registering the FIR had to come from Home Secretary and Union Home Minister Amit Shah. "The brakes on justice were being applied from above," he said, adding that police personnel at the station wanted to register the FIR but were prevented by "orders from above."

Lochab underwent two surgeries at AIIMS following the July 20 incident but continues to suffer vision impairment. He had submitted a seven-page complaint to police on August 14 demanding FIR registration before Gandhi's intervention.

The police registered the case under Sections 118 (voluntarily causing hurt or grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means) and 25 (act endangering life or personal safety of others) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), a police officer said.

According to his complaint, Lochab stated that he was participating in the students' protest against alleged irregularities in the Delhi Police recruitment examination and the NEET paper leak. When the crowd reached the Connaught Place area during a march towards Parliament, he moved towards the front while carrying the Tricolour.

He said that something

suddenly hit the right side of his body, including his chest, arm and eye. When he turned around, he saw a person in a blue uniform carrying a large gun and alleged that several metal pellets were fired from the weapon.

Lochab said he was hit around five or six times and started bleeding from his eye, face, hand and chest. He became disoriented and lost vision in his right eye, he said in his complaint. He further told police that he was initially taken by a motorcycle to Lady Hardinge Hospital and was later referred to Safdarjung Hospital. He was subsequently taken to the RPC Eye Centre and AIIMS Trauma Centre.

Lochab said he was admitted on the afternoon of July 21 and underwent his first eye operation on the night of July 22. He said his medical records and MLC clearly mention that the eye injury was caused by a pellet and doctors told him that the possibility of recovery of vision in the affected eye was less than one per cent, according to the complaint.

A CT scan at AIIMS showed more than 200 metal pellets or fragments in his body, including in and around his eye, head and chest near the heart, he said.

Some pellets, according to the complaint, are lodged in places where doctors have said they cannot be safely removed. Lochab said he was told that some pellets could remain inside his eye and near his heart for the rest of his life and his treatment would be prolonged.

In his complaint, he said that on July 25, he underwent another examination and could see only darkness through the affected eye. He was examined at the RPC Eye Centre/AIIMS outpatient department on July 31 and underwent a second eye operation on August 3 on the advice of doctors. His complaint states that his condition remained unchanged and doctors said the possibility of restoration of vision was negligible.

Lochab also said his medical prescription dated July 31 records that his injuries were caused by metal pellets and similar observations were made in his AIIMS medical records.

In his complaint, Lochab said he had been preparing to

join the Delhi Police but could no longer pursue that career because of the injury. His studies have also been disrupted, he said, adding that his family was not financially capable of bearing the cost of prolonged treatment.

No reason

territories of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh "are, and will always remain" an integral and inalienable part of India.

The spokesperson also addressed a separate dispute involving structures outside the diplomatic missions of the two countries.

He said Pakistani authorities had removed certain structures outside the Indian High Commission in Islamabad despite India's request. In response, Indian agencies removed temporary structures in the lane outside the Pakistan High Commission in New Delhi.

"Once it happened, we took what could be described as a proportional action," Jaiswal said. Pakistani authorities had removed security barricades and parking poles outside the Indian mission in Islamabad earlier this week. The subsequent removal of unauthorised structures in Delhi came as relations between the neighbours remained strained.

Ties deteriorated sharply after India's Operation Sindoor, which targeted terrorist infrastructure in Pakistan and Pakistani-occupied territories.

Govt denies

Reddy, who is currently in London, was scheduled to travel to the US after completing his UK visit on August 23. His programme included visits to Harvard University, MIT, the North-Eastern campus and a meeting with a team from Virginia Tech University in Boston. He was also scheduled to attend a 'Meet and Greet' organised by the Indian Overseas Congress (USA) in New York on August 26. He was due to return to Hyderabad on August 30.

Reacting to the decision, Reddy said the proposed visit was aimed at attracting leading global educational institutions to Telangana under the Centre's New Education Policy.

"I have always believed we should all think beyond politics

and elections when it comes to nation building and the future of the youth," he said.

Reddy said the visit was intended to help bring institutions offering education, skills and training to students in Telangana and Hyderabad. Despite the cancellation, he has directed officials to proceed with the planned US engagements and complete all MoUs and partnership agreements, according to the Chief Minister's Office.

The MEA has previously denied political clearance for overseas visits by former Delhi Chief Minister Arvind Kejriwal and West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee.

SC relaxes

law graduates from appearing in entry-level judicial service examinations and made three years of legal practice a prerequisite.

Under Friday's order, law graduates can apply for judicial service examinations despite not having completed three years of practice. Since more than a year has passed since the 2025 judgment, candidates applying under the current transition arrangement will be deemed to have completed one year of active practice. They will not have to submit a separate practice certificate for this deemed period.

Candidates selected through this recruitment process will undergo one year of compulsory training at the state judicial academy. The court said the training will count as one year of practice at the Bar for meeting the three-year requirement. During this period, trainee judicial officers will receive a fixed emolument equal to half the remuneration payable to a Judicial Magistrate First Class in the concerned state. They will also receive facilities and other benefits available to trainees at the judicial academy.

After completing the academy training, the candidates will undergo one year of structured law clerkship. The first six months will be spent under the supervision of a principal district judge, district and sessions judge, or a member of the higher judicial services. The remaining six months will be under a sitting judge of the concerned high court.

The court said this one-year clerkship will also be treated as equivalent to one year of Bar practice. At the end of the clerkship, the high court judge supervising the trainee will submit a reasoned assessment of the candidate's performance and suitability. A satisfactory evaluation will lead to appointment to the regular judicial post, along with the regular pay scale and other service benefits.

The rules will change for judicial recruitment notifications issued on or after April 1, 2027. From that recruitment cycle, every candidate seeking appointment as a Civil Judge (Junior Division) will have to possess at least one year of actual legal practice.

That practice will have to be verified through a Certificate of Practice. The certificate will be issued only after the candidate's presence and participation in effective judicial proceedings have been recorded through a mechanism to be prescribed by the high courts. Such participation may take place with a senior member of the Bar having at least 10 years of practice or otherwise.

Candidates from the post-April 1, 2027 recruitment cycle will also have to submit the required certificate with their applications. Even after completing one year of prior practice, selected candidates will undergo the same one-year judicial academy training and one-year clerkship. The clerkship will comprise six months under district-level judicial officers or members of the higher judicial services, followed by six months under a sitting high court judge.

The Supreme Court said the arrangement should not be treated as permanent without review. It said three years of institutional experience would be sufficient to assess whether the combination of limited prior practice, formal training and supervised clerkship achieves its intended purpose. The scheme will remain in force for five years, after which the court may reconsider it based on available material and experience.

Justice K Vinod Chandran, who had been part of the May 2025 bench, dissented from the majority view of CJI Kant and Justice Masih. He dismissed the

review petitions and did not agree to the modification of the earlier requirement.

No ethanol

The all-India average retail price of sugar has risen to Rs 56 per kg from Rs 48 on July 20. Ex-mill prices have climbed from Rs 47-48 to Rs 62 per kg in the past 7-10 days.

Chopra said the government had asked major sugar-producing states to act against hoarding, black marketing and speculation. States have also been told to prepare for an early start to crushing, around October 15. The government is considering lowering the current 400-tonne stock limit for dealers. From September 1, bulk consumers such as soft-drink and ice-cream manufacturers will be restricted to 15 days of consumption.

Sugar production in 2025-26 is estimated at 306 lakh tonnes, down from the earlier projection of 343 lakh tonnes due to pest disease and waterlogging from excess rain. Annual domestic consumption is around 280-285 lakh tonnes.

Chopra said diversion for ethanol was not responsible for the price rise. In 2022-23, nearly 43 lakh tonnes, or 12% of sugar stocks, were diverted for ethanol. In the current season, the figure is 28 lakh tonnes. He said only one-fourth of ethanol is now produced from sugar, with the rest mainly coming from maize.

The government has approved duty-free imports of 10 lakh tonnes of raw sugar by October 31. Refineries holding imported raw sugar under the advance authorisation scheme can also sell it domestically, potentially adding 3-4 lakh tonnes to supplies.

Chopra said mills could produce another 10-12 lakh tonnes in October after early crushing begins. Closing stocks are expected to be 33-35 lakh tonnes at the end of September 2026.

"We have always been assisting the sugar sector," Chopra said, adding that the government expects industry players to avoid actions that hurt consumers. He said adequate supplies would be maintained through the festive season and beyond.

MPOST

Briefs

Visit
Uncertainty

NEW DELHI: A Rashtrapati Bhavan communique on Friday announcing the cancellation of Saturday's Change of Guard ceremony to accommodate the full rehearsal of Bangladesh Prime Minister Tarique Rahman's ceremonial welcome was withdrawn, adding a fresh layer of confusion to the status of the high-profile visit.

India,Nepal
discuss
border issue

NEW DELHI: India and Nepal reviewed the full spectrum of their bilateral issues on border management and security; and reiterated their commitment to strengthening cooperation in these areas, a government statement said. The 14th edition of the two-day India-Nepal Joint Working Group (JWG) concluded in Dehradun, Uttarakhand on Friday, the Union home ministry said. The Indian delegation was led by Pausumi Basu, Joint Secretary (Border Management-I).

‘Security
forces need
support’

JAMMU: Lieutenant Governor Manoj Sinha on Friday underscored the vital role of community solidarity in eliminating terrorism, substance abuse and corruption, while promoting economic development and a spiritual renaissance in Jammu and Kashmir. Sinha was speaking after laying the foundation stone of Amriteshwar Sarovar.

Sajjan
Kumar
cremated

NEW DELHI: Former Congress Member of Parliament Sajjan Kumar, who was serving two life sentences in connection with the 1984 anti-Sikh riots, was cremated in the national capital on Friday, a day after his death at the age of 80. A large number of people gathered at the cremation ground as a decorated hearse carrying Kumar's mortal remains arrived.

‘INDIA IS PUSHING AHEAD WITH REFORMS ACROSS SECTORS’

Political stability makes India
global growth bright spot: PM

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, August 21

Prime Minister Narendra Modi asserted on Friday that reforms in all spheres are his government's commitment and that India continues to take several steps to ensure continued growth momentum.

Addressing the Economic Times World Leaders Forum, Modi also said India has political stability and continuity in its policies, and the world sees the country as a bright spot of growth and hope.

“India continues to take several steps to ensure continued growth momentum. India is pushing ahead with reforms across sectors and reforms are our commitment,” he said.

The prime minister said the world has many concerns regarding growth as resources are getting weaponised, but India is being seen as a bright spot of growth.

He said the NDA government has a clear roadmap for reforms, with a strong focus on governance. “Our government is rewarding higher production with incentives,” he said.

Modi alleged that it was the policy of the previous regimes to keep people in scarcity, so that they beg before the government for even basic needs.

He said the licence raj of the previous governments used to add to



PM Narendra Modi with former UK Prime Minister Boris Johnson at the ET World Leaders Forum

PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The prime minister said the world has many concerns regarding growth as resources are getting weaponised, but India is being seen as a bright spot of growth
- » He said the NDA government has a clear roadmap for reforms, with a strong focus on governance. “Our government is rewarding higher production with incentives,” he said

the burden of unemployment, whereas his government's production-linked incentive model is creating opportunities.

“We are not just changing regulations, we are changing the entire policy of regulations. Our government believes that there should be no regulation for doing something that has not been explicitly prohib-

ited under law,” he said.

The prime minister said his government is bringing next-generation reforms at the policy level and implementing reforms at the governance level and for ease of living.

“We are moving from the ‘prohibited-unless-permitted’ approach to the ‘permitted-unless-prohibited’ model,” he said.

Chh’garh CM enquires
about Nadda’s health



OUR CORRESPONDENT

Raipur, August 21

Chhattisgarh Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai met Union Minister for Health and Family Welfare JP Nadda at his residence in New Delhi on August 21. CM Sai enquired about Nadda's health and well-being and wished him good health. During the meeting, they discussed the expansion and strengthening of healthcare services in Chhattisgarh and reviewed the progress of health schemes being implemented with

the support of the Central Government.

Sai apprised the Union Health Minister of the State Government's efforts to ensure access to quality and affordable healthcare close to home. He said the healthcare system is being continuously strengthened, from primary healthcare services to advanced medical facilities. The CM laid special emphasis on improving healthcare access in remote, forested, and tribal regions, particularly Bastar and Surguja, where terrain poses challenges.

‘Mines Bill to
boost state
revenue’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, August 21

Union Minister Sanjay Seth on Friday said the amended mines and minerals legislation passed by Parliament recently will increase state revenue by curbing mineral theft and illegal mining.

The opposition parties, however, have alleged the new law would affect the financial autonomy of states and reduce their powers over their mineral-rich areas. The Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Bill restricts states from levying additional tax on mineral rights. The Centre, through the Bill, also seeks to take under its control the regulation of mineral-bearing lands having mineral contents in accordance with the parameters prescribed under the MMDR Act.

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

Lucknow, August 21

Former Ram Mandir Trust general secretary Champat Rai has alleged that former IAS officer and temple construction committee chairman Nripendra Misra acted arbitrarily in several matters related to the construction of the Ram temple and brought people of his choice into the committee.

In a nine-page document issued on August 18, Rai said some of the people associated with Misra were called to Ayodhya only once or twice in six years, while others were consulted on specific issues such as security.

Rai said decisions related to temple construction were taken in meetings of the construction committee, but in several cases decisions were subsequently altered and

Rai alleges Misra called shots
on key Ram temple decisions



priority was given to Misra's views. He also alleged that suggestions and decisions of other committee members were not given due importance in some matters.

The allegations assume significance as the construction committee was the key forum overseeing the execution of the Ram temple project, including the selection of construction agencies, consultants and design firms.

According to Rai, former NBCC chairman Anoop Mittal also attended the committee's meetings. He described Mit-

New Okhla Industrial Development Authority
Main Administrative Office, Sector-96, Noida, G.B Nagar (U.P.)
Website: www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE			
E-Tenders are invited for the following job from eligible bidders who are registered on Prahari Software, these may be uploaded by the dates specified below, and the received E-tenders will be opened on the dates indicated against them. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website: www.noidaauthorityonline.in & https://etender.up.nic.in . Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/amendments & corrigendum etc.			
A) Fresh-Tender Work:			
Sl. No	JOB NO	NAME OF THE WORK	Tender Amount (Rs. Lacs.)
1	54/GM/SM (WC-4)/ET 2026-27	M/o Building (Renovation of Kitchen of Old Age Home cum Orphanage Plot No.B-11, Sector-62), Noida.	21.95
The above tenders can be uploaded from dated 24.08.2026 to 08.09.2026 up to 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on dated 09.09.2026 at 11.00 AM.			
B) Re-Tender Work:			
Sl. No	JOB NO	NAME OF THE WORK	Tender Amount (Rs. Lacs.)
2	06/GM/SM (WC-1)/ 2026-27	P/L Thermoplastic Paint on Udyog Marg Sector-14A Flyover to Sector-11, T-Point, Noida.	29.50
3	36/GM/SM (WC-1)/ 2026-27	M/o Road (Beautification & Painting of Rajnigandha Underpass and P/F Polycarbonate sheets at Shahdara drain on MP-1 road, Noida.	27.09
The above tenders can be uploaded from dated 24.08.2026 to 31.08.2026 up to 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on dated 01.09.2026 at 11.00 AM.			
General Manager (Civil) Noida			
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‘Camerajeevi’ drama: BJP mocks
Rahul’s police station dharna

‘Symbol of the Cong party’s political desperation’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, August 21

The BJP on Friday termed Rahul Gandhi's dharna at a police station here a “camerajeevi” drama to stay in headlines and alleged that it was aimed at diverting public attention from the “embarrassment” faced by his party over its stand on the Vande Mataram issue.

The ruling party accused the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha of indulging in “politics of anarchy” and said his objective was not to seek justice or an investigation but to create a ruckus and challenge law and order.

Earlier in the day, Gandhi sat on a dharna at the Parliament Street police station, seeking registration of an FIR over pellet injuries suffered by a youth during the BJP-led July 20 protest. The protest ended more than six hours later after police registered the



complaint.

Talking to reporters, Union minister J P Nadda said, “Today, the entire country once again witnessed Rahul Gandhi's cheap and diversionary politics on full display outside the Parliament Street Police Station.”

Gandhi's protest was neither for students nor for justice, Nadda charged. “It was a symbol of the Congress party's political desperation and Gandhi's insatiable hunger for footage,” the senior BJP leader said.

Questioning Gandhi's motive behind holding the dharna, Nadda said the Supreme Court has

already taken cognisance of the incident during the July 20 protests and constituted a five-member high-powered committee headed by a former judge to examine the allegations of police excesses against student demonstrators.

“When the country's highest court is investigating the matter, what does Rahul Gandhi seek to prove by sitting outside a police station in front of the cameras? Has the Leader of Opposition lost faith in the country's judiciary?” he asked.

“The truth is that Rahul Gandhi is staging this ‘camerajeevi’ drama simply to remain in the headlines,” the former BJP president said. “This reflects his stubbornness and the frustration of the Congress,” Nadda said, alleging that Gandhi's objective was not to seek justice or an investigation but to create a ruckus and challenge law and order.

SC refuses relief to Sukhbir Badal

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, August 21

The Supreme Court on Friday dismissed a plea filed by Shiromani Akali Dal (SAD) chief Sukhbir Singh Badal seeking quashing of a 2017 criminal defamation complaint against him.

Badal had moved the apex court challenging an October 2025 order of the Punjab and Haryana High Court refusing to

quash the complaint and a March 2020 summoning order passed by a judicial magistrate. According to the complaint, Badal, the then deputy chief minister of Punjab, alleged in January 2017 that religious organisation ‘Akhand Kiratani Jatha’ (AKJ) was a “political front” of terrorist outfit Babbar Khalsa International.

The complainant, who filed the complaint in

individual capacity, had claimed that he was the chief spokesperson of AKJ.

Badal's plea came up for hearing before a bench of Justices Dipankar Datta and Sheel Nagu. “What is alleged against you (Badal)? You say that this organisation is a terrorist organisation and this complainant is the spokesperson of the other organisation which is the political front...,” the bench said.

Book on Rajiv
Gandhi’s
life, legacy
launched

AAISHA SABIR

New Delhi, August 21

A book on the life and legacy of former Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi was launched on Thursday for his 82nd birth anniversary, with senior Congress leaders and members of Parliament attending.

The book, authored by Debaprasad Roy, a close associate who witnessed Gandhi's entry into and exit from national politics, examines the former Prime Minister's foresight, neutrality, and patriotism, Roy says.

Roy's biography moves beyond conventional narratives on controversial issues surrounding Gandhi, drawing on his close proximity to the political figure to illuminate aspects of his leadership.

Uncertainty clouds B'desh PM's visit to India
No clarity yet on proposed visit amid official communication pullback

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, August 21

India and Bangladesh are continuing to hold back-channel talks to firm up a much-anticipated visit to New Delhi by Prime Minister Tarique Rahman after plans for his two-day visit this month fell through due to certain contentious issues, people familiar with the matter said on Friday.

The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) publicly announced earlier this month that India invited Rahman for a bilateral visit as well as to attend the outreach session of the upcoming BRICS summit in New Delhi.

In the last few weeks, Indian High Commissioner

KEY POINTS

- » In the last few weeks, Indian High Commissioner to Dhaka Dinesh Trivedi held a series of meetings with top political brass of Bangladesh including Rahman
- » “I have nothing to say on this matter. If I have any updates, I will share them with you,” MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said on Friday when asked about Rahman's visit to New Delhi.



to Dhaka Dinesh Trivedi held a series of meetings with top political brass of Bangladesh including Rahman, underlining the need to create a conducive environment to further advance the bilateral ties.

“I have nothing to say on this matter. If I have any updates, I will share them with you,” MEA spokesper-

son Randhir Jaiswal said on Friday when asked about Rahman's visit to New Delhi.

Earlier in the day, the Rashtrapati Bhavan withdrew an official communication that mentioned cancellation of Saturday's Change of Guard ceremony to accommodate the full rehearsal of Rahman's

ceremonial welcome.

The people cited above said there was plan for Rahman to visit India on August 23 and 24 but it fell through in view of certain issues.

The back-channel talks between Dhaka and New Delhi are underway to finalise his trip, they added.

FALLOUT OF SHILLONG VIOLENCE

Arson, petrol bomb attacks on govt properties reported in Meghalaya

MPOST BUREAU

Shillong, August 21

Incidents of arson and petrol bomb attacks on government properties were reported across Meghalaya on Friday, as tensions prevailed following violence during the Khasi Students' Union black-flag bike rally two days ago.

An office that housed the National People's Party previously at Lachumiere was targeted with a petrol bomb around 5 am, but it did not explode, police said.

A police and forensic team reached the spot, collected evidence and registered a case, they said.

In West Khasi Hills, two government vehicles were gutted after miscreants set them ablaze at Nongstoin on Thursday night.

Petrol bombs were also hurled at the offices of the Superintending Engineer, PWD, at Mawkhlam, Nongpyndeng, and the SDO, Mawshynrut Civil Sub-Division and minor damages were reported.

In Shillong, a petrol bomb was hurled at the Nongmensong police outpost around 9.30 pm on Thursday.

It landed inside the premises and set a chair on fire. No injuries were reported.

In Ri-Bhoi, two government vehicles and a motorcycle were set ablaze at the Water Resources Depart-



Transporters block the Assam-Meghalaya border at Jorabat amid tensions following violence during a KSU motorcycle rally in Shillong, in Guwahati

PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- » In West Khasi Hills, two government vehicles were gutted after miscreants set them ablaze at Nongstoin on Thursday night
- » The Byrnihat-Jorabat road was blocked from both sides on Friday amid the Assam-Meghalaya taxi standoff

ment premises in Saiden around 2 am.

Two vehicles and the motorcycle were gutted, while another government vehicle was partially damaged.

In South West Khasi Hills, a petrol bomb was lobbed at the Animal Husbandry and Veterinary Officer's office at Mawlangwir around 1 am.

The device landed on

the roof but did not cause damage.

The Centre has approved the deployment of five companies of central forces -- four CRPF and one RAF -- in the state till August 25 to assist the state police in maintaining law and order.

Police have so far registered 15 FIRs in connection with Wednesday's violence in Shillong, East Khasi Hills

SP Vivek Syiem said.

Meanwhile, the Byrnihat-Jorabat road was blocked from both sides on Friday amid the Assam-Meghalaya taxi standoff, prompting the Ri-Bhoi district administration to advise commuters to avoid the route until further notice.

Travellers heading between Meghalaya and Guwahati were advised to use alternative routes, particularly those travelling for medical treatment, airport and railway connections and other emergencies.

At least 31 vehicles were damaged and several pedestrians assaulted during the violence on

Wednesday.

Guwahati-based cab operators and transport workers subsequently stopped Meghalaya-registered vehicles at Jorabat and Khanapara.

Hundreds of passengers were stranded, while ambulances and vehicles carrying essential services were exempted.

Police said protesters damaged a Meghalaya-registered taxi at Khanapara before the situation was brought under control.

In a bid to defuse interstate tensions, Chief Ministers Conrad K Sangma and Himanta Biswa Sarma agreed to work together to restore peace and normalcy following the violence and disruptions.

Meghalaya Deputy Chief Minister Sniawbhanglang Dhar and Assam Cabinet Minister Atul Bora were subsequently designated to hold an inter-ministerial meeting and discuss measures to ease the situation and ensure smooth movement of people and vehicles between the neighbouring states.

Assam drivers' associations and tourist cab operators have sought an apology from the Meghalaya chief minister and tourism minister, compensation for damaged vehicles and injured persons, and assurances on the safety of Assam-registered vehicles and drivers travelling to the hill state.

Jauhar Univ: ED finds 'evidence' of government 'fund diversion'

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

Rampur, August 21

The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has found evidence indicating alleged diversion of government funds and suspected use of unaccounted money in the construction of Mohammad Ali Jauhar University in Rampur, officials said.

The university is controlled by the Jauhar Trust, headed by former Uttar Pradesh minister Azam Khan and his family members. The findings emerged during ED searches at the university, trust offices, premises linked to its office-bearers, chartered accountants and companies associated with its construction.

Documents allegedly indicate misuse of funds released under MP and MLA local area development schemes.

According to sources, funds sanctioned for public works in Rampur were allegedly withdrawn in cash and used for construction at Jauhar University. Private firms awarded government contracts allegedly carried out works linked to Jauhar Trust properties instead.

The ED is examining Jauhar Associates and CK Associates, which allegedly received around Rs 86 crore through government contracts without maintaining proper accounts.

Investigators are also scrutinising officials involved in awarding and executing the contracts.

'Biased': MEA rejects anti-RSS remarks by top USCIRF officials

'USCIRF lacks any credibility'

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, August 21

India on Friday trashed remarks by senior officials of US Commission on International Religious Freedom (USCIRF) calling for sanctions against the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) and asked Washington not to extend diplomatic courtesies to its leaders.

External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal, rejecting the remarks, described the USCIRF as a "biased" organisation.

"We are all aware that the organisation that you are referring to has been making disparaging and inflammatory remarks about India," he said at his bi-weekly media briefing.

"It is a biased organisation. I would say that we should keep away from such organisations as they have their own agenda and lack any credibility," he said.

Jaiswal was responding to a question on the remarks by the USCIRF officials.

USCIRF Commissioner Gene Mills said RSS leaders, even when affiliated with the Indian government, should not be honoured with high-level meetings or diplomatic courtesies.

"Instead, the USG (US Government) should focus on imposing sanctions on RSS members found

INSIGHT

» USCIRF Commissioner Gene Mills said RSS leaders should not be honoured with high-level meetings or diplomatic courtesies

» In March, the USCIRF annual report criticised India for alleged violations of religious freedom

responsible for FoRB (freedom of religious belief) violations," Mills said.

USCIRF chair Asif Mahmood described RSS as an umbrella organisation whose sub-groups have perpetrated attacks on religious minorities.

USCIRF posted the remarks by Mahmood and Mills on its X account.

In March, the USCIRF annual report criticised India for alleged violations of religious freedom and backed "targeted sanctions" on individuals and entities such as the RSS and Research and Analysis Wing, holding them responsible for the matter.

In its recommendation, the USCIRF also called for designating India as a "country of particular concern" or CPC, for engaging in and "tolerating systematic, ongoing, and egregious religious freedom violations, as defined by the International Religious Freedom Act (IRFA)".

Son jumps off hill; parents fall to death in bid to save him

MPOST BUREAU

Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar, August 21

Three members of a family died in Maharashtra's Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar district on Friday after a domestic dispute over a mobile phone led to a tragic sequence of falls from a hilltop, police said.

The incident occurred in the Tisgaon area under Waluj MIDC jurisdiction. The deceased were identified as Murlidhar Chandgude (48), his wife Sangita and their 19-year-old son Kunal, residents of Zalta Phata.

According to police, the incident began around 10 am when Kunal went up the hill after an argument with his parents over his demand for a new mobile phone.

Worried about his safety, Murlidhar and Sangita followed him to persuade him to return home.

Villagers, police and fire brigade personnel reached the spot and launched a rescue effort.

Fire officials attempted to place a safety net at the base of the hill, but Kunal repeatedly moved along the cliff edge, preventing them from positioning it.

Around 1 pm, Murlidhar approached his son to console him. Kunal then jumped from the steep hill, prompting his father to make a desperate attempt to save him. Both lost their balance and fell from the hilltop.

Sangita, who witnessed her husband and son fall, subsequently jumped from the hill in grief, the official said.

Police recovered all three bodies and sent them for further formalities. Further details are awaited.

Briefs

Pb gears up for Ravidas Jayanti...

CHANDIGARH: Punjab will organise 92 drone shows across all Assembly constituencies from September 1 as part of year-long celebrations marking the 650th Prakash Purab of Sri Guru Ravidas, Cultural Affairs Advisor Deepak Bali said. The shows will be held in 3 clusters and depict his life and teachings.

Haryana to fast-track AgriStack...

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Friday directed districts to complete targeted farmer registrations on the Centre's AgriStack platform by August 24. Officials were asked to complete the drive on a war footing. Farmers will receive unique IDs, enabling easier access to government schemes.

Guj hooch tragedy: 10 critical

BHAVNAGAR: Sixty-one persons have been affected so far due to consumption of spurious liquor in Gujarat's Bhavnagar district, with eight deaths confirmed and 10 patients being critical, officials said on Friday. As many as 25 persons, who consumed the liquor containing methanol, are still undergoing treatment.

RSS meet deliberates on demographic imbalance

Visakhapatnam, August 21

The three-day all India coordination meeting of RSS here deliberated on demographic imbalances, falling fertility rate and India's youth population, a senior Sangh leader said on Friday.

Addressing a press conference here, RSS leader C R Mukunda said the conclave discussed changing demographics in India.

"Demographic change is happening. As we all know, all over the globe, this is a very challenging thing. There are many countries which are going through an aging population challenge," he said.

However, he noted that India is currently endowed with the world's largest youth population while its entire population is also the largest in the world.

Though India is blessed with these two strengths, Mukunda noted that demographic scientists flagged that aging crisis will hit the country in the next three to four decades.

FALLING FERTILITY RATE AND INDIA'S YOUTH POPULATION ALSO DISCUSSED

Further, he underscored that fertility rate is diminishing with demographic imbalances, leading to societal disturbances in some regions.

"Certain classes or certain communities are seeing a massive increase in their population while other communities and classes are seeing a decrease--this imbalance was taken up seriously here and it was discussed," he said.

Further, Mukunda noted that the meeting deliberated on what the Sangh-inspired organisations are thinking and planning to face these challenges.

In a press release, the RSS said the meeting held serious discussions on demographic change and imbalance.

AGENCIES

J'khand HC stays notifications cancelling appointments of CDPOs, JSSC-CGL recruits

Ranchi, August 21

The Jharkhand High Court on Friday stayed the notifications cancelling the appointments of Child Development Project Officers (CDPOs) and those recruited through the JSSC-CGL examination.

The court on Thursday had stayed the notifications cancelling the 11th and 13th Jharkhand PSC exams, besides putting a clamp on the order cancelling the appointments of food safety officers.

"A bench of Justice Deepak Roshan today stayed the operation of the notification cancelling recruitments through Jharkhand Staff Selection Commission-Combined Graduate Level examination (JSSC-CGL), besides the one cancelling the appointments of CDPOs," petitioner's counsel Indrajit Sinha said.

He said a counter affidavit will be filed by the state on September 7, and by September 14, petition-



Successful candidates of recruitment exams celebrate after the HC stayed the notifications cancelling their appointments

PTI

ers will submit a rejoinder.

"Also, the court has made it very clear that on September 15 it will hear the matter at 12.15 pm, earlier than scheduled 2.15 pm. The court also said that the matter has been taken on a priority basis," he said.

Advocate Amritansh Vats, who also represented the petitioners, said the court was of the view that if the need arises, it will dispose of the matter by conducting day-to-day

hearings from September 16.

"Today, the CDPO and JSSC-CGL matters were listed afresh. The court has granted an interim stay on both these matters on the ground of the principle of natural justice," he said.

Vats said a PIL was earlier filed regarding the JSSC-CGL examination.

Hailing the stay, the government employees protesting the cancellation of their appointments said the decision was

SAINI RECALLS JOURNEY OF PERSEVERANCE

'From operating computer at BJP office to CM..'

MPOST BUREAU

Chandigarh, August 21

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Friday recalled his journey from operating a computer at the BJP office in Panchkula in 1996 to becoming the Chief Minister, telling young entrepreneurs that his rise was built on hard work, patience and persistence rather than shortcuts.

Addressing the 'Gen-H Yuva Udyami Chaupal' at Gurugram University, Saini said, "Meri Yatra Mein Koi Lift Nahi Thi, Main Mehnat Roop Se Seedhiyan Chadhkar Yahan Tak Pahuncha"



Haryana CM Nayab Saini along with others pose for photographs during the Gen-H Startup Summit

PTI

(There Were No Shortcuts in My Journey, Only the Steady Climb of Hard Work).

Recalling his 2009 electoral defeat, Saini said he

RECALLING HIS 2009 ELECTORAL DEFEAT, SAINI SAID HE RETURNED TO THE PEOPLE THE VERY NEXT DAY AND REFUSED TO ALLOW THE SETBACK TO DEFINE HIM

tunities to serve as minister, MP, State BJP president and Chief Minister.

He said that in 1996, when Narendra Modi was BJP in-charge for Haryana, a computer was sent to the party office in Panchkula. "While operating that com-

puter, I had never imagined that one day I would become Chief Minister," Saini said.

Interacting directly with youth, the Chief Minister urged them to treat failure as a learning experience and make consistency, credibility and patience their strengths. He described the younger generation as "Gen-HB -- Haryana-Bharat", calling it "the heartbeat of India".

Saini said technology had transformed opportunities for youth, with digital payments, social media, cloud technology and AI reducing the distance between ideas and execu-

tion. He said Haryana now has 12,500 startups and 17 unicorns, compared with negligible startups before 2014. He urged youth to become job creators and highlighted startup policies, incubation centres, MUDRA loans and research funding. He also said families should allow children to choose their careers.

On sports, Saini said Haryana has thousands of sports nurseries, 25 residential academies and 550 new Sports Department posts. Around 18,000 medal-winning sports persons have received cash awards worth Rs 742 crore over the past 12 years.

EDITORIAL

Rethinking ‘Development’

India’s expanding road network is central to its economic ambitions, but the manner in which infrastructure is built matters as much as the kilometres added. The Rajasthan High Court’s intervention in a road-widening project, staying demolitions and directing that ten trees be planted for every tree felled, brings a development dilemma into sharp focus. Compensatory plantation has become the standard response whenever highways, flyovers, metros or public projects require trees to be removed. The arithmetic appears reassuring: cut one, plant several. Ecology, however, does not work like a balance sheet. A mature tree that has grown over decades cannot be replaced overnight by ten saplings. Its canopy provides shade, absorbs carbon, moderates local temperatures, supports biodiversity, holds soil and helps regulate water. A sapling may eventually perform some of these functions, but only if it survives long enough to mature. The ecological loss is immediate; compensation may take decades. In increasingly hot Indian cities and towns, that difference matters enormously.

This does not mean roads should not be widened or projects abandoned whenever trees stand in their path. India needs better highways, safer junctions and efficient urban mobility. The problem lies in treating ecological damage as something to be calculated after engineering plans have effectively been finalised. Too often, routes are selected, drawings prepared and budgets sanctioned before serious consideration is given to whether mature trees can be retained. Once construction reaches that stage, felling is presented as unavoidable and plantation as the remedy. The sequence needs reversing. Environmental considerations should enter the drawing room with engineers and planners, not arrive later as a clearance condition. Could a carriage-way shift slightly? Could an old avenue be incorporated into a median? Could road width vary briefly, or an alternative alignment preserve valuable tree cover? Such choices may complicate construction or increase costs, but good infrastructure is not necessarily infrastructure built by the cheapest or straightest route. Development should adapt intelligently to the landscape rather than automatically clearing it.

The High Court’s direction should therefore encourage governments to look beyond plantation ratios. Where removal is genuinely unavoidable, compensatory planting must be scientifically planned, locally appropriate and monitored for survival rather than celebrated through impressive numbers on paper. Project agencies should remain responsible for saplings for several years, with survival rates publicly disclosed. More importantly, mature trees must carry greater weight in project appraisal because their ecological value cannot be measured simply by counting trunks. India’s infrastructure transformation and environmental responsibilities need not be competing objectives. Climate change, extreme heat and deteriorating air quality have made existing green cover valuable public infrastructure in its own right. The sensible principle is neither “never cut a tree” nor “plant ten elsewhere”. It is to design first to preserve what can be saved, remove only what cannot, and compensate meaningfully for unavoidable loss. A modern road should improve connectivity without leaving an unnecessarily poorer landscape behind.

LETTER



letter2editor.mp@gmail.com.

Personal Choice

The Delhi High Court has rightly reaffirmed that consenting adults have the freedom to choose their partners and live together without interference. Family disagreement cannot become intimidation or violence. Social conventions must not override constitutional liberty. Protecting individual choice is essential in a society where relationships still face prejudice and coercion.

RAHUL KUMAR SINGH,
DWARKA

You can also send your comments to The Editor, Millennium Post, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

Clarion Call against Radicals

Beyond the restoration of a historic song lies a deeper political question about whether national identity should remain hostage to communal sensitivities and vote-banks

POLITICAL FAULTLINES



TUHIN A SINHA

THE WRITER IS A NATIONAL SPOKESPERSON OF THE BJP

There are moments in a nation’s history when a song becomes much more than a song. It becomes a memory, a movement, a marker of civilisational identity and, sometimes, a test of political courage. Vande Mataram has been all of these for India.

Written by Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay and incorporated into his celebrated novel Anandamath in 1882, Vande Mataram acquired a significance far beyond literature. Its popularity exploded during the Swadeshi movement following Lord Curzon’s partition of Bengal in 1905. At a time when the British Raj was deliberately dividing Bengal, Vande Mataram became a cry of resistance. It was shouted by protesters, sung at political gatherings and embraced by revolutionaries. The motherland became the emotional centre of the freedom struggle.

That history matters because Vande Mataram was born not as an instrument of communal division but as a response to political domination and the humiliation of a subjugated civilisation. Its central idea was simple: the nation is worthy of reverence. And yet, decades



A confident civilisation need not dilute its heritage to appear secular

later, the Congress leadership chose to truncate it.

In 1937, the Congress Working Committee decided that only the first two stanzas should be sung at national gatherings. The stated rationale was that the later stanzas contained religious imagery that might offend sections of the population. The Muslim League had objected strongly to Vande Mataram, and Congress ultimately accommodated those objections by restricting the song’s official rendition.

The political message of that decision was unmistakable: when communal sensitivities were raised, India’s civilisational expression had to make way. Nearly nine decades later, India has changed. The Narendra Modi government’s decision in 2026 to restore the full rendition has reopened a historical conversation that should never have been closed. The later stanzas invoke the motherland through powerful imagery of strength, knowledge, abundance and freedom. They draw upon the cultural vocabulary of the civilisation in which the song was written. They are part of a literary and nationalist composition—not a theolog-

THE BATTLE OVER VANDE MATARAM IS ULTIMATELY ABOUT HOW INDIA UNDERSTANDS ITSELF TODAY

ical test that citizens are being asked to pass.

And here lies the irony. The same Congress that once compromised on Vande Mataram in the name of communal sensitivities is now opposing its restoration. The question naturally arises: is the Congress becoming the new Muslim League? That is deliberately provocative, but the political trajectory deserves scrutiny. Consider the pattern. The proposed Prevention of Communal and Targeted Violence Bill of 2011, associated with the UPA-era National Advisory Council, was criticised by its opponents for creating an asymmetric framework of communal accountability. The controversy

was not merely legal; it reflected the broader politics of treating communal questions through the prism of majority-minority categories.

Then came the Congress opposition to the Citizenship Amendment Act. Whatever the political arguments around CAA, the legislation sought to provide a pathway to Indian citizenship for persecuted non-Muslim minorities from Pakistan, Bangladesh and Afghanistan. Congress opposed it, joining a political campaign in which sections of the radical ecosystem became increasingly prominent.

Then there was triple talaq. After the Supreme Court declared instant triple talaq unconstitutional, the Modi government sought legislation to give the judgment statutory teeth. Congress opposed several provisions of the legislation, arguing that criminalisation was inappropriate. And in Kerala, Congress remains the principal constituent of the UDF, whose alliance with the Indian Union Muslim League is an established political reality.

None of this means that every Muslim citizen—or every Muslim political organisation—is radical. That distinction is essential.

India’s Muslims are equal citizens, and communal stereotyping is both unjust and antithetical to the Constitution. But there is an equally important distinction between respecting a community and surrendering national symbols to the veto of communal politics. That is precisely why Vande Mataram matters.

Those who view India merely as a territorial republic may find the song’s civilisational language uncomfortable. Those who understand India as a spiritual democracy and an ancient civilisation expressed through a modern Constitution have little difficulty embracing it.

The idea of Bharat as Mata is not an exclusionary proposition. It is an expression of gratitude to the land that sustains its people. It does not diminish the citizenship of an Indian because of his or her faith. The real issue, therefore, is not whether someone is Muslim or Hindu. It is whether India’s politics will be governed by equal citizenship or by selective vetoes.

For decades, pseudo-secular politics taught India that civilisation must apologise for itself. Every invocation of its heritage had to be diluted, qualified or carefully edited lest somebody be offended. That era is ending. Vande Mataram is emerging once again as a clarion call—not against a religion, but against the politics of appeasement, selective secularism and civilisational self-denial. The choice before India is larger than one song. It is between a confident civilisation that respects every citizen equally and a politics that constantly fragments citizens into vote banks.

India has seen where the latter road can lead. It has already witnessed Partition. The country cannot afford another generation of politicians quietly planting the seeds of cultural separation in the name of secularism. History may forgive political mistakes. It does not easily forgive those who refuse to learn from them.

And India is watching.
Views expressed are personal

The Great Newsroom Cull

Journalism may survive the business crisis, but will enough journalists survive it?

AT VANTAGE



SHUTAPA PAUL

THE WRITER IS AN AUTHOR AND MEDIA ENTREPRENEUR

When I look back at my journalistic career, one job really stands out. Not for the quality of work (which, I dare say, was phenomenal!), nor for one of the owners reaching notoriety for alleged involvement in her daughter’s murder. The job remained indelible mostly for the sheer and constant waves of management upheaval. I vividly recall a day during one such management switch. Employees who had shown up to work were led into glass-walled meeting rooms, handed envelopes, and then escorted by security guards to collect their belongings from their workstations in the newsroom. This bloodbath continued for a few days; none of us knew who was next, and the air was heavy with depression, forebod-

ing, and unimaginable stress. Even though I was not part of the layoffs, the guilt and sadness of watching colleagues lose their jobs stayed with me.

Last month’s layoffs at another media group, *TV Today*, jolted me back to those unhappy days. Almost 120 employees showed up to work, only to be handed full and final settlement papers and given their marching orders. Earlier this year, *NDTV* placed 100 employees on performance improvement plans, signalling possible future layoffs. The *BBC* is apparently planning 2,000 job cuts due to funding problems. *The Associated Press* may be offshoring its production jobs to India – good news for newsmen here, but likely to cause job losses in the US, with many others joining the queue. An industry that reports on job cuts everywhere else is reeling from its own, but there are few reports about it.

The news and media sector has consistently been hit by job cuts over the last decade, with regular rounds of organisation-wide firings, both in India and globally. Major news organisations in India and abroad have all been shedding employees. I think it’s also safe to say that the glory days of journalism, as practised by large media houses, are behind us. Today’s media is highly corporatised, coerced to bow to advertisers and marketing teams rather than hard news. Finding that balance is both impossible and an urgent necessity today. Call it operational pressures, drying up of advertisements, or acquiescence to



Job cuts save balance sheets but can quietly hollow journalism

THE BLOODBATH AT NEWS ORGANISATIONS QUIETLY CONTINUES WITH THE BUSINESS GETTING TOUGHER, AND JOB LOSSES ADDING TO THE SECTOR’S WOES

their masters, but the news business is perhaps one of the most challenging to sustain in current times. Realists have been ringing the death knell for newspapers for well over two decades, but the good ol’ broadsheet still sustains itself – struggling, grappling, but surviving.

The Covid-19 pandemic made a difficult situation even tougher, ensuring that deadweight and white-elephant media professionals were shown the door. This culling has now reached the middle and senior levels of editorial teams as well. As per a recent news report by *exchange4media*, over 1,000 Indian media professionals lost their jobs in 2025; by August this year, that mark had already been breached in 2026. *The Press Gazette* reports 3,434 journalism job cuts in 2025 across the US and UK; it was 3,875 in 2024 and 6,000 in 2023. The advent of artificial intelligence (AI) has sadly, and yet expectedly, impacted news organisations as well. With economics calling the shots more than journalistic ethics, it’s not surprising to see research and fact-checking teams shrinking, if not vanishing completely. The clock has been ticking on them all; AI has only exacerbated their dismissal.

Digital media is a welcome innovation that has helped organisations keep up with the times. It has also meant that the line between content creation and news, and that between content creators/influencers and journalists, is increasingly getting blurred. It’s the price that the news sector pays to stay afloat, along with the dodgy race for television TRPs (target rating points). The digital age has also given a fighting chance to independent journalists and indie news platforms to pursue anti-establishment stories and expose happenings that are given a wide berth by others. And not all media organisations have folded. The one I’m writing this op-ed for – *Millennium Post* – is on its way to completing 15 years; I’ve written my weekly column for almost half of that time. The news sector’s story is not dead; it’s never been smooth or the most profitable, but those who are in it for the right reasons show a resilience unseen in other sectors. Money has rarely been the driving force behind journalism; the pursuit and reporting of truth have been. If journalism is necessary today, and we must all agree that it is, then the fourth pillar needs to be protected; it needs to be patronised. It’s disheartening that dozens of media professionals are being sacked across the world, even at media houses backed by business magnates helming super-successful conglomerates. If they can’t forego a bit of profit for the greater good, then that says a lot about the world we live in.

Views expressed are personal

URGES THEM TO DEVELOP SOLUTIONS FOR EVERYDAY NEEDS

PM assures support to space startups

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 21

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Friday assured full support of the government to young space entrepreneurs and urged them to explore how space technology can be used in agriculture, livestock management, dairy, environment and other areas that affect people's everyday lives.

Interacting with CEOs and founders of 20 space startups here, Modi also hailed them for showing remarkable courage by entering a new and demanding domain of space startups as they have taken risks, trusted the reform process & remained consistent in their efforts. He assured them of the government's full support and called for greater collaboration between space companies and organisations in other sectors to expand the use of their technologies.

"I assured the space startups that government of India will continue to stand with them as they build India's capabilities for the future. India can offer the world a strong,



Prime Minister Narendra Modi interacts with young entrepreneurs and innovators from India's space sector PTI

innovative and commercially viable model in the space sector," he said.

Modi also urged the startups to explore how space technology could contribute to "agriculture, livestock management, dairy, environment and many other areas that touch everyday lives".

The prime minister suggested, "Companies working on space debris could work with environmental organisations to scale up their technologies. Space technology companies working with the agricultural sector could collaborate with agricultural universities and departments to help farmers make better informed deci-

sions and maximise their output." The prime minister said the startups made insightful presentations on their work and appreciated the government's space reforms and the opportunities they had created for the industry to grow.

"It was wonderful to meet the Yuva Urja of India's space sector... young entrepreneurs and innovators who have shown remarkable courage by entering a new and demanding domain. They have taken risks, trusted the reform process and remained consistent in their efforts. Due to this, India has achieved a lot in the space sector in the last few years," he said.

KEY POINTS

- » Modi also hailed CEOs and founders of 20 space startups for showing remarkable courage by entering a new and demanding domain of space startups
- » The startups made insightful presentations on their work & appreciated the government's space reforms and the opportunities they had created for the industry to grow, the PM said

He said India's private space ecosystem could become a major force for the country and the world and called for an ecosystem in which the world looks to India when thinking about the space sector. India's space sector can act as a magnet to attract global talent, companies and investment to the country, Modi said, urging industry players to rapidly strengthen India's position globally.

The prime minister also encouraged space startups to engage with Atal Tinkering Labs, saying they could spark curiosity among schoolchildren and inspire the next generation to participate in the space sector.

He recalled that opening the space sector to private participation had generated significant enthusiasm and created new opportunities for industry.

The prime minister said many countries either could not invest in the space sector or did not wish to do so, presenting India with a major opportunity to rapidly strengthen its position in the global space industry. He also encouraged space companies to explore new applications of their technologies and focus on how these could make people's lives easier, while calling for greater collaboration between space-sector firms and companies working in other areas.

The CEOs of leading companies in the space sector working in diverse fields ranging from building rockets and reusable semi-cryogenic launch vehicles, avionics, satellites, advanced propulsion system, space and defence intelligence, removing space debris, AI-powered hyperlocal weather and climate intelligence, among others, participated in the interaction.

ANI NEWS

Port Louis, August 21

India and Mauritius are set to expand their energy partnership beyond conventional petroleum products to clean and sustainable fuels, with Mauritius having prepared a National Biofuel Policy Framework, Union Petroleum Minister Hardeep Singh Puri said.

Puri said the two countries' energy cooperation would increasingly cover future energy security and cleaner fuels, building on their existing partnership in petroleum products.

"India-Mauritius energy partnership is now not only limited to today's needs, but is also moving towards future energy security and clean energy," Puri said on X. Mauritius is a founding member of the Global Biofuels Alliance and has prepared its National Biofuel Policy Framework with support from the alliance, Puri said. This creates scope for greater cooperation between the two countries in clean and sustainable fuels, beyond crude oil and refined petroleum products.

The minister said India's growing refining capacity and its position as a net



Union Petroleum Minister Hardeep Singh Puri

'INDIA'S ENERGY STRENGTH IS NOW A STRENGTH FOR OUR FRIENDS AS WELL,' PURI SAID

exporter of refined petroleum products are also allowing the country to play a larger role in the energy security of partner nations.

"India's energy strength is now a strength for our friends as well," Puri said, adding that as uncertainty around energy supplies grows globally, India can serve as a reliable and stable energy source for its partners.

India currently has 23 refineries processing around 270 million metric tonnes of crude oil annually, according to Puri. He said the country's refining capacity is being expanded

HIGHLIGHTS

- » 'The two nations' energy cooperation would increasingly cover future energy security & cleaner fuels, building on their existing partnership'
- » India currently has 23 refineries processing around 270 million metric tonnes of crude oil annually, according to Puri
- » India's refining strength should be viewed not only as an asset but also as a responsibility to remain a dependable energy partner

and its refining strength should be viewed not only as an asset but also as a responsibility to remain a dependable energy partner.

"India's refining power is now not just our strength, but also our responsibility and our global credibility," Puri said. He said the India-Mauritius partnership demonstrated how India's energy capabilities could support the economic resilience of friendly countries. The cooperation would help Mauritius strengthen its energy security while also creating opportunities for future collaboration in sustainable fuels.

Forex kitty swells by \$9.905 bn to \$716.907 bn

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai, August 21

India's forex reserves jumped \$9.905 billion to \$716.907 billion during the week ended August 14, the RBI said on Friday.

In the previous reporting week ended August 7, the overall kitty had jumped \$14.136 billion to \$707.002 billion.

Reserves had expanded to an all-time high of \$728.494 billion during the week ended February 27 this year before the onset of the Middle East conflict that led to several weeks of a drop as the rupee came under pressure and the RBI had to intervene in the forex market through dollar sales.

For the week ended August 14, foreign currency assets, a major component of the reserves, increased \$7.225 billion to \$581.851 billion, the central bank's data showed.

Value of gold reserves increased \$2.679 billion to \$111.417 billion during the week, the central bank said.

The special drawing rights (SDRs) were down \$5 million at \$18.74 billion, the apex bank said.

India's reserve position with the IMF was up \$5 million to \$4.899 billion at the end of the reporting week, according to the apex bank's data.

GSTAT prez expresses concern over dismal appeal filings

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 21

Goods and Services Tax Appellate Tribunal (GSTAT) President Justice (Retd) Sanjaya Kumar Mishra on Friday expressed concern over the low number of cases filed with the appellate tribunal, noting that only 74,758 cases have been recorded so far.

The GSTAT e-filing portal was made operational on September 24, 2025, and the deadline for filing appeals, which were time-barred, was July 31, 2026.

Mishra said as many as 3.5 lakh cases were filed before the first appellate authority, and this is indica-

tive of the number of second appeals that could be filed before the GSTAT.

However, since the cases were filed in physical mode, there is no conclusive data available on the number of cases disposed of by the first appellate authority.

The first appellate authority is a Commissioner (Appeals) level officer whom a taxpayer can approach to appeal against an order or decision issued by a junior officer. GSTAT is the second appellate authority & provides a unified platform for resolving conflicts between taxpayers & tax authorities. Mishra said 74,758 cases have been filed before the GSTAT since

September last year, while about 30,000 more tokens have been issued, which is contrary to the initial expectation.

Last month, GSTAT had allowed businesses whose cases were getting time-barred on July 31 to generate tokens on the e-filing portal.

Once the token was generated, businesses had 60 days to file the case before the appellate tribunal. "I was expecting something around 2-2.5 lakh cases. I don't know why (the number of cases filed is less). It may be that businesses have closed down; maybe they were cases of fake ITC claims..." Mishra said.

Government working on amendments to Actuary Act, 2006, says DFS official

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 21

The Department of Financial Services is closely coordinating with the Institute of Actuaries of India (IAI) to bring certain amendments to the Actuary Act, 2006, a senior government official said on Friday.

"We are actively, as the Department of Financial Services, coordinating with the institute for bringing certain amendments to the Actuary

Act of 2006," Debasish Prusty, Additional Secretary, DFS, Ministry of Finance, said.

He said the proposed amendments will soon be discussed by the competent authorities.

"And very soon it is going to be discussed by the competent authorities and we will see that the latest innovations can be driven through certain set of amendments," he said.

The official also highlighted the expanding

role of actuaries amid changes in the insurance and financial sectors.

Actuaries are increasingly moving beyond traditional areas such as life and general insurance pricing, reserving and risk mathematics into health insurance analytics, pension and retirement system design, climate and catastrophe risk modelling, artificial intelligence and machine learning-driven risk assessment.

The Institute of Actu-

Markets end flat on elevated crude oil prices, Sensex closes higher by 3.11 pts

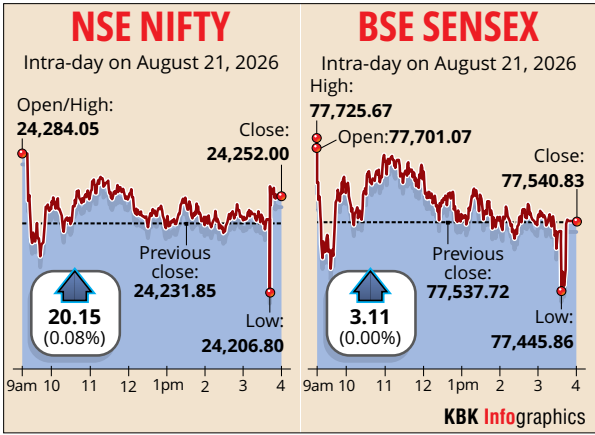
The rupee appreciates by just 3 paise to 95.71 against US dollar

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai, August 21

Market benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty ended flat on Friday, a day after registering a rebound, as elevated crude oil prices induced by geopolitical uncertainties and a sharp fall in the US markets made investors cautious.

In a largely range-bound trade, the 30-share BSE Sensex ended almost unchanged from the previous close at 77,540.83, up 3.11 points.

The 50-share NSE Nifty



also ended flat, up 20.15 points, or 0.08 per cent,

at 24,252. Among the Sensex firms,

Power Grid, Bharat Electronics, Kotak Mahindra Bank, NTPC, Bajaj Finserv and Asian Paints were the biggest winners.

Trent, Maruti, Inter-Globe Aviation and HCL Tech were among the laggards.

The rupee pared initial gains and settled on a flat note, higher by just 3 paise at 95.71 against the US dollar on Friday.

On the weekly front, the BSE benchmark declined 468.42 points, or 0.60 per cent, and the Nifty dipped 114 points, or 0.46 per cent.

Starlink would help connect least served parts of India: Elon Musk

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Washington, August 21

SpaceX founder Elon Musk has pitched Starlink's satellite internet services as a way to connect underserved parts of India, particularly rural areas.

"Starlink would help the least served in India, especially in rural areas," Musk said in a social media post on Thursday local time.

He was responding to a post by X account DogeDesigner, which also pushed for Starlink Services in



India to connect remote villages. "11,256 of India's listed villages still had no 4G coverage as of May 2026," DogeDesigner said.

"India had 1.093 billion internet subscriptions in March 2026, but only 440.87 million were rural.

Rural subscription density was 48.31 per 100 people, compared with 126.80 in urban India," it said.

Musk's comments came amid reports that Starlink has made a fresh application to offer satellite communication services in India. The Indian National Space Promotion & Authorisation Centre had earlier rejected Starlink's application for its Gen 2 satellite network, saying some of its features and the radio frequencies it planned to use didn't meet Indian needs.

RBI Board reviews global and domestic challenges

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Chennai, August 21

The Central Board of Directors of RBI on Friday reviewed global and domestic challenges, including risks to the economic outlook. The Board also reviewed various operational areas of the RBI, including the functioning of its Committees and the Ombudsman Scheme.

"The Board in its meeting reviewed the current economic situation, global and domestic challenges, including risks to the economic outlook," the central bank said after the 624th



meeting of the Board under the Chairmanship of Governor Sanjay Malhotra. Deputy Governors Swaminathan J, Poonam Gupta, Shirish Chandra Murmu, Rohit Jain and other Directors of the Board – Revathy Iyer, Sachin Chaturvedi, Anand Gopal Mahindra and Somnath Sreedhara Panicker – attended the meeting.

PNB inks MoU with Indian Army to offer PNB LUXURA & Parakram Credit Cards

The cards offer a curated range of benefits & fee waivers

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, August 20

Punjab National Bank (PNB) has signed an exclusive MoU with the Indian Army to offer PNB LUXURA Credit Card and PNB Parakram Credit Card.

Designed exclusively for serving personnel/JCOs/OR of the Indian Army, the credit cards offer a curated range of benefits, lifestyle privileges and fee waivers. The MoU was signed by



Maj Gen VK Purohit, AVSM, YSM, SM, on behalf of the Indian Army, and Deepak

Kumar, General Manager, Public Relations & Credit Card Division, on behalf

of PNB at the Indian Army Headquarters, Delhi.

The ceremony was graced by AG, Lt.Gen Viresh Pratap Singh Kaushik, PVSM, UYSM, YSM, SM, DG, MP & PS; Lt. Gen Rajeev Puri, AVSM, VSM representing the Indian Army in presence of Ashok Chandra, MD & CEO, Maj Gen Dinesh Singh Bisht (Retd.), Chief Defence Banking Advisor, Sudhir Dalal, CGM, and Amit Kumar Singh, AGM, from Punjab National Bank.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE

Jindal Steel, one of India's leading steel manufacturers, and the Indian Institute of Technology Hyderabad (IITH) have signed an MoU to establish the Jindal Steel Centre of Excellence (CoE) for High-Strength, Value-Added and Value-Engineered Steel Products and Solutions at the IIT Hyderabad campus.

GOVT WILL NOT ALLOW ‘COPYCATS’ TO GET ANY BENEFIT

India-designed mobile phones likely in 10-14 months under MPMS: Min

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 21

Indigenously designed mobile phones with Indian companies owning their IP rights are expected to hit the market in 10-14 months under the Rs 62,500-crore Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme (MPMS), Union Electronics and IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said on Friday.

The minister said the government will be rigid on screening Indian brands and will not allow “copycats” to get any benefit under the scheme.

Announcing the notification of the MPMS, Vaishnaw said companies applying for the scheme will have to prove that they own intellectual property (IP) rights of the design used in manufacturing the phones.

“In this target segment of developing Indian brands, we are very particular that the design has to be your own design. It cannot just be a copycat. They have to



Union Electronics and Information Technology Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw

come up with the design and prove that the IP is their own. We see three players who have the potential of coming up in a time frame of, let us say, about 10-14 months from now,” Vaishnaw said.

The minister said the government will not show any flexibility while evaluating the design of these phones. “We have asked three players to come up with design options. The challenge we have given them is that the design has to match the best in your segment. It cannot be a

design which cannot compete with the best in your segment,” Vaishnaw said.

Designing a product like a mobile phone with its own patented technology will need huge technical expertise. At present, no mobile phone is entirely designed in India.

Korean major Samsung has a research and development team of more than 3,000 people in India, contributing in development of some features used in its Galaxy smartphones. Among domestic brands, Lava International and Ai+

KEY POINTS

- » Companies applying for the scheme will have to prove that they own intellectual property (IP) rights of the design used in manufacturing the phones, Vaishnaw said
- » The minister said the government will not show any flexibility while evaluating the design of these phones

claim that they design their smartphones locally.

The MPMS has been divided in two parts – incentivising mobile phone manufacturing, which is target segment 1 (TS1), and supporting Indian mobile phone brands as target segment 2 (TS2).

Under TS1, mobile phone companies, including electronics contract manufacturers, with a turnover of Rs 10,000 crore in FY26 will be eligible for MPMS benefits. The minister said the incentive will remain fungible between the two

segments.

Mobile phone companies, including electronic manufacturing services (EMS) firms applying for TS2, will need to have 51 per cent Indian ownership, and a turnover of Rs 1,000 crore in FY26 to be eligible for participation in the scheme.

“We had a mobile manufacturing ecosystem. But because of tax issues and Chinese onslaught, it became impossible for them (Indian firms) to compete in the market. Now that we have been able to establish the ecosystem back in our country, time has come... to focus on developing the Indian brand,” Vaishnaw said.

The MPMS has been introduced following the expiry of mobile production-linked incentive scheme in March 2026.

MPMS will be in place for five years starting this fiscal year. Applicants with majority Indian ownership can get a gestation period of one year.

Retail share in equity derivatives declines 18% to 87.5 lakh in FY26

ANI NEWS
New Delhi, August 21

Retail participation in India’s equity derivatives segment declined 18 per cent year-on-year to 87.5 lakh active individual traders in FY26 from 106.2 lakh in FY25, marking the first annual decline in the trader base since FY16, according to a SEBI study released on Thursday.

The survey noted “Active individual traders in the Equity Derivatives Segment (EDS) declined 18% year-on-year, from 106.2 lakh in FY25 to 87.5 lakh in FY26, the first year-on-year decline in the trader base since FY16.”

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI), in its study said the decline in participation was more pronounced among smaller traders with annual turnover below Rs 10,000.

The report said FY26 marked the first reversal in the long-term expansion of individual participation in equity derivatives. It noted that the trader base, despite the decline, remained substantially



above pre-FY21 levels.

The decline in the trader base was accompanied by a sharp fall in the number of new entrants. New trader entries into the equity derivatives segment fell nearly 40 per cent year-on-year to 20.8 lakh in FY26 from 34.3 lakh in FY25 and 43.1 lakh in FY24.

At the same time, exits from the segment increased substantially. Nearly 46 lakh traders who participated in FY25 did not trade in FY26, compared with 26 lakh exits in FY25, an increase of about 76 per cent.

SEBI said the number of exits rose from 4.2 lakh in FY22 to 45.7 lakh in FY26, while the exit rate as a share of the previous year’s trader base increased from 16 per cent to 43 per cent.

“the FY26 decline appears to have been a partial retrenchment rather than a complete reversal of

the post-FY21 expansion,” the report said. The study also highlighted a moderation in overall activity in the equity derivatives segment. Notional turnover increased 4.2 per cent in FY26, compared with 20.4 per cent growth in FY25. Futures activity declined 15 per cent, while options premium turnover grew 7 per cent.

Options continued to dominate retail participation, with 99.3 per cent of individual traders having traded options during FY25-FY26. The report said 93 per cent of traders traded only options, while less than one per cent traded only futures.

Despite the fall in participation, losses remained substantial. Aggregate net losses of individual traders declined 18 per cent to Rs 91,685 crore in FY26 from a revised Rs 1.12 lakh crore in FY25. However, the average loss per trader increased marginally by 2 per cent to Rs 1.17 lakh from Rs 1.13 lakh.

The share of loss-making individuals fell to 87.7 per cent in FY26 from 90.9 per cent in FY25.

Australia, NZ eye deeper trade ties with India

AGENCIES
Mumbai, August 21

India, New Zealand and Australia see significant scope to deepen trade and investment ties in critical minerals, agricultural technology, space, clean energy and education, senior officials said on Friday.

New Zealand Trade and

Enterprise Consul General Graham Rouse said the recently upgraded India-New Zealand strategic partnership aims to double bilateral trade in three years. He said the proposed FTA, currently awaiting ratification, could create further opportunities.

Rouse highlighted agricultural technology, par-

ticularly improving apple yields in India, and space technology as promising areas for cooperation.

He also said New Zealand companies could partner with Indian MSMEs. Australian Consul General in Mumbai Paul Murphy said Australia aims to raise bilateral trade with India from around \$50 billion

currently to \$100 billion by 2030. He identified renewable energy, critical minerals, education and electric vehicle supply chains as key areas.

Australia, the world’s largest lithium source, can supply raw materials to Indian manufacturers as they move up global supply chains, Murphy said.

Govt gets 29 FDI plans of ₹4,895.65 cr, under revised rules for cos with 10% Chinese stake

AGENCIES
New Delhi, August 21

As many as 29 FDI proposals worth Rs 4,895.65 crore have been reported under the government’s revised rules allowing overseas companies with up to 10 per cent Chinese or Hong

Kong shareholding to invest through the automatic route, the Commerce Ministry said on Friday.

The revised framework, notified on May 1, 2026, removed the requirement for prior government approval for such investments in sectors where FDI

is permitted under the automatic route, subject to sectoral conditions. Earlier, companies with even a minor shareholding from a country sharing a land border with India required government approval.

The relaxation, however, does not apply to

entities registered in China, Hong Kong or other neighbouring countries.

The 29 proposals, reported up to August 20, span sectors including information technology, AI, manufacturing, pharma, data centres and transport services.

SPORT

‘NOT FINISHED YET’: TREESA-GAYATRI IN SEMIS; SATWIK-CHIRAG OUT

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 21

India’s Treesa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand assured themselves of a medal at the World Championships with a come-from-behind win over China’s Jia Yi Fan and Zhang Shu Xian in the women’s doubles quarter-final here on Friday.

The unseeded Indian pair, which is on a comeback trail after Treesa recovered from an injury, toiled for one hour nine minutes to produce one of the biggest wins of their career, a 16-21 21-15 21-13 triumph to cruise to the last four stage and be assured of at least a bronze medal.

India last claimed a BWF World Championships medal in women’s doubles in 2011, when Jwala Gutta and Ashwini Ponnappa won the bronze in London.

“We were trying our best. But after the first game, we changed our tactics. It was a bit tricky in the beginning. But I think we were calm and managed to win,” Gayatri said.

Treesa credited the advice of chief coach Pullela Gopichand to remain composed and stay in the present for helping them negotiate pressure situations.

“He always said just calm down and be in the

Pair-fectly poised for glory



Treesa Jolly (left) and Gayatri Gopichand Pullela after winning their thrilling encounter

present moment. I think that really worked today. I think that’s the kind of advice we got behind us,” she said.

Gayatri said there was no specific plan to target one particular opponent, but admitted the pair were deliberately trying to keep their legs moving and remain patient.

“I think nothing like that. We don’t want to reveal too much of the

strategy. I think we were just rotating. We just wanted our legs to move and just to be calm on court,” she said.

Treesa admitted the significance of the victory only truly sank in when they reached the final stages of the deciding game.

“I think when we got last 21 points. Because with those kind of players, it’s like when you actually win,

that time only we will actually process that,” she said.

“I think right now, just processing this one, we are going to the semi-finals and being on the podium. But it’s not finished yet. This is not the ending. We came here with a goal.”

Satwik-Chirag pair bows out

Star Indian men’s doubles pair Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty’s dream of win-

IN SHORT

- » India last won a BWF World Championships medal in women’s doubles in 2011, when Jwala Gutta and Ashwini Ponnappa claimed bronze in London
- » The world No. 5 Satwik-Chirag pair, who have won bronze medals at the 2022 and 2025 editions, lacked the required sharpness and crashed to an 18-21 9-21 loss in just 36 minutes against Wang and Liang

No room for error as India take on flying Dutchmen

‘Do-or-die match for us, need a masterclass’

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Amstelveen, August 21

India will face their biggest test when they take on co-hosts and reigning Olympic champions the Netherlands in the World Cup second round opener here on Saturday, aware that there is virtually no room for error in their bid to reach the semifinals.

India’s biggest concern remains their tendency to lose control after making strong starts. They led Pakistan 3-0 and 4-1 before allowing the arch-rivals to fight back in a 5-3 victory, while a 2-1 half-time lead against England slipped away as they conceded twice in the third quarter and eventually lost 2-4.

On the other hand the Dutch team won all three matches convincingly, defeating New Zealand 5-1, Argentina 3-1 and Japan 4-1.

Against one of the most lethal attacking sides in world hockey, India can not afford lapses.

Harmanpreet wary
Harmanpreet Singh has warned his squad that a quarter-by-quarter effort won’t cut it, and only a full 60-minute masterclass will



India must put on a superlative display

PTI

INDIA HAD DEFEATED NETHERLANDS 3-2 IN THE LAST MATCH OF FIH PRO LEAGUE 2025-26 SEASON IN JUNE

keep their campaign alive.

India will have to start from scratch in the second round. England and pool A topper Netherlands will have a three-point cushion as they had beaten India and Argentina in the first round respectively. That makes both the second-round matches and the Dutch and Argentina games virtual knockouts for India.

“Playing well in patches won’t work. We have to play good hockey till the whistle is blown. We have to maintain the same body language and attitude, that is the most important thing,” Harmanpreet said on the eve of the match.

“We have video-analysed our mistakes in the last three matches, and the focus is on not repeating them. Defense has to be impeccable as we know that we can create opportunities in the opponents’ circle and earn PC. But mistakes in the backline are not acceptable. We must not concede goals on silly mistakes,” he said.

Bahutule backs struggling Kuldeep

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Colombo, August 21

Defending the struggling Kuldeep Yadav, India’s spin bowling coach Sairaj Bahutule on Friday asserted that the left-arm wristed spinner is in the team management’s “scheme of things” ahead of the sec-

ond Test, and said one mediocre outing will not define the bowler.

Kuldeep could only pick one wicket while bowling 25 overs across two innings in the first Test, whereas left-arm spinner Manav Suthar and Ravindra Jadeja shared 14 wickets among them. “He’s been bowling

extremely well. It’s just the situation which arose in Galle, he had to play a different role. For me, he has always been a match-winner and he definitely is in the scheme of things,” Bahutule told the media here. “All the spinners are struggling with the soft ball.”



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Colombo, August 21

Mindful of his underwhelming returns against left-arm spin, India skipper Shubman Gill on Friday spent considerable time fine-tuning his game against that variation at the team’s training ses-

sion ahead of the upcoming second Test against Sri Lanka here. In the first Test at Galle, Gill fell to left-arm spinner Prabath Jayasuriya twice while making 16 and 8. India, nonetheless, won the game by 165 runs. The second Test begins here on August 23.

In general, Gill’s travails

against the orthodox left-armers has its genesis in his inadequate covering of the line, and it was evident at Galle while he struggled to negate Jayasuriya.

Gill has been dismissed 11 times by left-arm spinners in Test cricket across 42 games.

Kuldeep Yadav attended

the nets but he neither bowled nor batted. However, off-spinner Saransh Jain bowled a few overs to Rishabh Pant and Shubman Gill, and even squared up the former on a couple of occasions. But it will be naive, at least at this stage, to take it as a sign of Jain replacing Kuldeep.

जिला अभियंता का कार्यालय जिला परिषद, रामगढ़

अति-अल्पकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

ई-निविदा सं० :- ZP/RAMGARH/08/2026-27

कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी :-
मद-DMFT

सूच संख्या	योजना का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि	अग्रघन की राशि	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य (रु०)	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
1	2	3	4	5	6
1	वितरपुर प्रखण्ड अन्तर्गत बड़कीपोना बघलता मुफा होते हुए पोना पर्वत मंदिर तक रैम्प (सीढ़ी) एवं सड़क का निर्माण।	78,31,600.00	1,57,000.00	10,000.00	06 (छ: माह)
2	Renovation of S N High School Barkakana, Patratu	76,05,400.00	1,53,000.00	10,000.00	06 (छ: माह)
3	Renovation and Construction of 4 Additional Class Room in SS +2 High School, Patratu, Ramgarh	72,68,300.00	146000.00	10,000.00	06 (छ: माह)
4	Renovation of PM Shri UPG High School Bariyatu, Gola (Ramgarh)	1,11,39,800.00	223000.00	10,000.00	06 (छ: माह)
5	Renovation of UPG High School Barlanga, Gola (Ramgarh)	1,55,60,200.00	312000.00	10,000.00	06 (छ: माह)
6	Renovation of UPG High School Sangrampur, Gola (Ramgarh)	94,49,700.00	189000.00	10,000.00	06 (छ: माह)
7	Construction of 8 ACR and Miscellaneous Works in PM Shri High School, Rajrapra Project.	1,10,08,100.00	221000.00	10,000.00	06 (छ: माह)
8	Construction of Boys and Girls (2x2=4 Unit) Toilet, Parking Shed & Multisports at UPG Basic High School, Murubanda, Block- Chitarpur	51,99,700.00	104000.00	10,000.00	06 (छ: माह)
9	Construction of 8 ACR and 2 ACR in S. S High School, Mandu, Block- Mandu, Ramgarh.	1,52,32,700.00	305000.00	10,000.00	06 (छ: माह)
10	Construction of 4 ACR, Kitchen Shed, Parking Shed, Boundary Wall Fencing in Dr. R.M.L.S. High School, Bongahara, Block- Mandu, Ramgarh	78,10,100.00	157000.00	10,000.00	06 (छ: माह)

1. वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि- दिनांक- 27.08.2026

2. ई-निविदा डालने / प्राप्ति की तिथि एवं समय- दिनांक 27.08.2026 से दिनांक 03.09.2026 अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक।

3. निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय- दिनांक - 05.09.2026 को पूर्वाह्न 11:00 बजे।

4. निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का पदनाम एवं पता- जिला अभियंता, जिला परिषद, रामगढ़।

5. ई-निविदा प्रक्रिया का दुस्माच नं०- 9801557645

6. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि केवल Online माद द्वारा स्वीकृति होगी।

7. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि का ई- मुगतान सर्वेदक द्वारा जिस बैंक खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रघन की राशि वापस होगी। अगर बैंक खाता को बंद कर दिया जाता है। तो उसकी सारी जवाबदेही सर्वेदक की होगी।

8. निविदा Double Bid पद्धति से होगा।

9. इस निविदा में जिला परिषद, रामगढ़ के अंतर्गत प्रजीकृत समूचित श्रेणी के सर्वेदक माग से सकंमें।

विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए वेबसाइट Jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं कार्यालय के सूचनापट्ट पर देखा जा सकता है।

ह०/-
जिला अभियंता,
जिला परिषद, रामगढ़।

PR 388097 (District) 26-27 (D)

Jharkhand Industrial Infrastructure Development Corporation Limited (JIIDCO)

(A Govt. of Jharkhand Undertaking)

5th Floor, Udyog Bhawan, Ratu Road, Ranchi-834001 (Jharkhand)

e-mail- jiidcoitd@gmail.com www.jiidco.co.in CIN U45208JH2004GOI011078

Letter no.2026/Engg.Cell/3007

2nd CALL

Date:21.08.2026

Designation and Address of the Advertiser

:- Chief Engineer, JIIDCO 5th Floor, Udyog Bhawan, Ratu Road, Ranchi-834001

1. Mode of submission of tender

:- Online through www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in

2. Publishing on website

:- Date 24.08.2026

3. Period downloading of Bidding Documents

:- Date 24.08.2026 to 02.09.2026 Time 4.00 P.M.

4. Bids online submission

:- Date 24.08.2026 to 02.09.2026 Time 4.00 P.M.

5. Bid opening date (Technical)

:- Date 03.09.2026 Time: 5.00 P.M.

6. Details of works

:-

Sl. No.	Name of work	Estimate Cost (Rs.)	Amount of Earnest money (E.M.D) (Rupees)	Cost of BOQ (Non-refundable in Rs.) (Inclusive GST)	Time of completion of work
1	2	3	4	5	6
I	Construction of PCC Road Over Existing Road from Phase-3 C-1/1A to Phase-4A-3, Balidih Industrial Area, JIADA	4,61,00,748.00	4,62,000.00	11,800.00	06 Months
II	Construction of PCC Road Over Existing Road at Phase-4 Balidih Industrial Area, JIADA	3,98,40,153.00	3,99,000.00	11,800.00	06 Months
III	Construction of PCC Road Over Existing Road at Phase-3 E-1 to Phase-4A-1/1, Balidih Industrial Area, JIADA	4,61,61,080.00	4,62,000.00	11,800.00	06 Months
IV	Construction of PCC Road Over Existing Road from N.H. to Phase-3 E1 & Phase-11D to A115 via Housing Colony, Balidih Industrial Area, JIADA.	4,60,47,383.00	4,61,000.00	11,800.00	06 Months
V	Construction of PCC Road Over Existing Road at Phase-3 Balidih Industrial Area JIADA.	4,62,71,492.00	4,63,000.00	11,800.00	06 Months
VI	Construction of PCC Road Over Existing Road at Phase-2 Balidih Industrial Area JIADA.	4,62,14,577.00	4,62,500.00	11,800.00	06 Months
VII	Construction of PCC Road Over Existing Road at Phase-1 Balidih Industrial Area, JIADA.	4,30,27,365.00	4,30,500.00	11,800.00	06 Months

7. Tender fee (non-refundable) & EMD is to be received through online mode only. Bidders can use internet banking facility for faster processing of Tender fee Alternately, Bidders can use NEFT/RTGS challan generated for the tender from http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in. Refund will only be issued to Originated bank account used for the payment of EMD. So, bidders are advised NOT to close the above Bank Account used for online payment NEFT/RTGS of EMD.

No Hardcopy/Physical copy is required to be submitted for tender opening/evaluation. However, Department may ask original documents for verification before award of contract.

8. Bid Validity

:- 180 days

9. Place of opening of Technical Bid

:- Office of M.D. JIIDCO, 5th Floor, Udyog Bhawan, Ratu road, Ranchi-834001

10. For any information/complaints the department helpline no. M.b.no. 9204500332 may be contacted.

11. Further details can be seen on website- www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in.

12. Any Corrigendum or Addendum will be notified in website:- www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in only.

Note: (i) Any change can be seen on website www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in

(ii) Any other information can be seen on www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in

(iii) The estimated cost mentioned above in S.No. 06, column no. 3 is approximate which may be increased or decreased.

Sd/-
Chief Engineer, JIIDCO Ranchi

PR 388172 Jharkhand Industrial Infrastructure Dev Co Ltd(26-27)#D

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Montu Kumar/ Mamta Devi/ LBDEL00003788051	Part of Property No., 27/88 (Plot No 88, Block No 27), 1st Floor, Without Terrace/Roof Rights & 25% Share In Stilt Floor For Parking, Out of Khasra No 4277/3664/637 And 4382/3614/637, Village Chandrawali Alias Shahdara, Vishwas Nagar, Gali No 7, Shahdara Delhi- 110032/ August 20, 2026	April 29, 2026 Rs. 25,00,538/-	Delhi NCR
2.	Sudhir Kumar Chauhan/ Pinky Chauhan/ LBDEL00001409345	Mig Flat No. F-1, First Floor, (Without Roof Right), Built on Plot No. B-1/17, Situated At DLF Dilshad Extn. No II, Village Brahmputr Alias Bhupura Pargana Loni Tehsil & District Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh- 201001/ August 20, 2026	February 11, 2026 Rs. 9,31,117.95/-	Delhi NCR
3.	Manpreet Singh/ Paramjeet Kaur/ LBDEL00006213811	Property Bearing No.25 Block-H-3, Upper Ground Floor, Without Roof/ Terrace Rights, Vikas Puri, New Delhi- 110018 (Along With 1/4th Undivided Sharecar Parking At Stilt Area And 1/4th Undivided Portionate Rights of The Said Land Thereto), Owned By Manpreet Singh & Paramjeet Kaur/ August 20, 2026	March 24, 2026 Rs. 19,93,901/-	Delhi NCR

The above-mentioned borrower(s)/guarantor(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: August 22, 2026

Place: Delhi/Ncr

Sincerely Authorised Officer,
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

COURT NOTICE

(U/o 5 Rule 20 CpC)

IN THE COURT OF

Ms. Annu

Judicial Magistrate - Ist Class,

CHARKHI DADRI

Smt. Renu

Vs.

Shahjad and others

CNR No. HRCD02-000677-2024

Next Date:- 10-09-2026

PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:

1. Shahjad Son of Molad Son of bhim

2. Smt. Mamkaur Widow of Sankar Son of Molad

Both Resident of - shishwala, tehsil and district charkhi dadri

In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 10-09-2026 at 10:00 am.

For details logon to https://highcourtcd.gov.in/2mod

district notice & district

CHARKHI DADRI

Sd/Ms. Annu

Judicial Magistrate - Ist Class

Dated 21.08.2026 Charkhi Dadri

Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER PMGSY (JKRRDA) JAMMU.

NOTICE INVITING e-TENDERS

e-NIT No:-CEJ/PMGSY/ 837 of 2026-27 Dated:-19/08/2026

Chief Engineer PMGSY (JKRRDA) Jammu on behalf of The Government of Jammu & Kashmir, invites e-tenders on %age Above/Excess (+) OR %age Below/ Less (-) basis (I.e. on Percentage-Rate Basis) from approved and eligible Contractors registered with J&K U.T.Govt, CPWD, Railways or equivalent and other State/U.T.Govts up to 1700 Hrs. on 07-09-2026 for each of the following works.

Sr. No.	Name of Work/ Package No.	Name of the PIU	Const. Part (Rs. In Lacs)	Maint. Part (Rs. In Lacs)	Total (Rs. In Lacs)	Cost of Documents (Rs. In Lacs)	Bid Security (EMD) @2% of total cost rounded to the nearest thousand (Rs. In Lacs)	Time Allowed for completion	Call of tender	Time and date of opening of technical bids	Class of Contractor
1	i) Balance work for construction of road from L-034 Kundradhan to mamankot upper, Package No: JK14-567, Regular PMGSY, Batch-1, 2017-18, Stage-I, Block-Mahore, District: Reasi (Length=27.0 Kms) ii) Balance work for construction and maintenance road from L-034 Kundradhan to mamankot upper, Package No: JK14-662 Regular PMGSY, Batch-I, 2017-18, Stage-II, Block-Mahore, District: Reasi(Length=27.00 Kms)	Mahore	1249.92	130.29	1380.21	0.20	27.60	15 Months	2 nd	09-09-2026 11:00 Hrs.	Any registered contractor with State/ U.T. PWD/CPWD/ Railways or equivalent qualifying eligibility criteria as provided in the Standard Bidding Documents can tender for the works

Date and Time Schedule

S.No	Particulars	Date	Time
1	Date of issue of tender notice	19-08-2026	1700 hrs
2	Document Download / Sale Start Date	21-08-2026	1855 hrs
3	Pre-Bid Meeting	24-08-2026	1200 hrs
4	Bid submission start date	25-08-2026	1000 hrs
5	Bid submission end date	07-09-2026	1700 hrs
6	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bids	09-09-2026	1100 hrs
7	Date & Time of Opening of Financial Bids	To be notified after technical evaluation is completed	To be notified after technical evaluation is completed

1. The bidding document can be downloaded from the website and bids shall be submitted ONLINE ONLY in electronic format through the e-tendering portal.

2. For complete details and instructions, bidders are advised to refer to Standard bidding document(SBD).

3. For further details and updates, bidders may visit the official website https://pmgsytendersjk.gov.in

No:-CEJ/PMGSY/16475-549

Dated:-19-08-2026

DIP No:DIP/J-8589/26

Sd/-Chief Engineer PMGSY (JKRRDA) Jammu

For and on behalf of The Government of Jammu and Kashmir

KIND ATTENTION RAIL PASSENGERS!

IMPORTANT NOTICE

INTRODUCTION OF REGULAR RUN OF GORAKHPUR JN.-DELHI JN.-GORAKHPUR JN. AMRIT BHARAT EXPRESS TRAIN

For the convenience of rail passengers, it has been decided to introduce the regular run of Train No. 05057/05058 Gorakhpur Jn.-Delhi Jn.-Gorakhpur Jn. Special as per the details mentioned below:-

15095/15096 Gorakhpur Jn.-Delhi Jn.-Gorakhpur Jn. Amrit Bharat Express (Weekly)

Train No. 15095	ARR.	DEP.	STATIONS	Train No. 15096	ARR.	DEP.
---	22:45		Gorakhpur Jn.	06:30	---	
23:21	23:23		Khallilabad	04:56	04:58	
23:51	23:54		Basti	04:28	04:31	
01:40	01:50		Gonda Jn.	02:50	02:55	
02:42	02:44		Burhwal Jn.	01:40	01:42	
04:40	04:50		Sitapur Jn.	00:02	00:12	
07:48	07:50		Bareilly	18:39	18:41	
09:03	09:08		Moradabad	17:18	17:23	
11:42	11:44		Ghaziabad	14:52	14:54	
12:50	---		Delhi Jn.	---	14:10	

Days of run : 15095 Ex. Gorakhpur Jn. from 27.08.2026 (every Thursday) and 15096 Ex. Delhi Jn. from 28.08.2026 (every Friday).

Composition: Sleeper & General

For detailed information, please call RailMadad Helpline No. 139 or visit enquiry website: www.enquiry.indianrail.gov.in

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SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Deepak, S/o Chander Parkash, R/o A-64, Harkesh Nagar, Okhla Phase-II, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 298/2025, U/s 12/09/55 Delhi Public Gambling Act, P.S. Kalindi Kunj, New Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said Deepak cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said Deepak has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said Deepak accused of FIR No. 298/2025, U/s 12/09/55 Delhi Public Gambling Act, P.S. Kalindi Kunj, New Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 22.09.2026.

By Order - Sh. Kawal Singh

Judicial Magistrate First Class-10

South-East District, Room No. 307

Saket Courts, New Delhi

DP/11789/SE/2026

New Okhla Industrial Development Authority

Main Administrative Building, Sector-86, Noida, G.B. Nagar (U.P.)

Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER

E-Tenders are invited from firms/contractors registered with UPLC Lucknow for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website: www.noidaauthorityonline.in & http://etender.up.nic.in Please ensure to see these website for any changes/ amendments & corrigendum etc.

1. Job No.-03/COMPUTERCELL/COM. ACCESS.(I)/26-27, Procurement of Computer Accessories of Rs. 29,80,617/-

The above tenders can be uploaded by date 03.09.2026 upto 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date 04.09.2026 at 11.00 AM.

प्रबंधक (कम्प्यूटर सैल)

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Prosenjit Dutta Proprietor/Authorised Signatory of M/S SRD Industries, R/o: Uttar Krishanapur, Part-II, Sonal Road, Silchar-788704, Assam has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case CC No.: 4021/2019, U/s: 138 NI ACT, P.S. Darya Ganj, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said Prosenjit Dutta cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said Prosenjit Dutta has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Prosenjit Dutta of P.S. Darya Ganj, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 28.09.2026.

By Order

Sh. Pranjal Gangwar

JMFC-03, Room No. 202,

Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/11539/CD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused Jayanti Prasad S/o Hardeva Mal R/o B-564 Swami Shardhanand Park, Libas Pur, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in FIR No. 372/2014 U/s 448/420/467/120B/34 IPC, PS Aman Vihar, Delhi and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused Jayanti Prasad cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Jayanti Prasad has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that Jayanti Prasad in FIR No. 372/2014 U/s 448/420/467/120B/34 IPC, PS Aman Vihar, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 26.09.2026.

By order

Ms. Shagun

Judicial Magistrate First Class-06

North West

Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/11700/RD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C/84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) (1) Rizwan S/o Hakimuddin R/o Loni Safi Kabristan, Near Pani ki Tanki, Loni, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh; (2) Shahrukh S/o Farukh R/o Vanthala Cyber City Colony, Gali No. 1, Loni Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in FIR No. 228/2019 U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act, PS Jahangir Puri, District North-West, Delhi and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) (1) RIZWAN (2) SHAHRUKH can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) (1) RIZWAN (2) SHAHRUKH has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) (1) RIZWAN (2) SHAHRUKH of FIR No. 228/2019 U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act, PS Jahangir Puri, District North-West, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated 12.10.2026 at 10:00 AM.

By Order

Sh. Sahil Gupta

Justice Magistrate First Class-07

(Court Matter) (North) Room No. 06, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/11694/NW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Suleman @ Salman, S/o: Salluddin, R/o: E-252, JJ Colony, Sector-24, Rohini, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No.: 329/17, U/s: 380/411 IPC, P.S. North Rohini, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said Suleman @ Salman cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said Suleman @ Salman has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Suleman @ Salman of P.S. North Rohini, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 17.10.2026.

By Order

Ms. Aakanksha

JMFC-03, North West, Room No. 107,

Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/11619/RD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused Prem Kumar Proprietor & Authorised Signatory of RM Enterprises having Office Address, Plot No. C-38, Khasra No. 262/258/217/4, C-Block, Rajan Babau Road, Adarsh Nagar, Delhi-110033 has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in CT No. 5367/2019 U/s 138 NI ACT, PS Model Town, Delhi and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused Prem Kumar cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Prem Kumar has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that Prem Kumar in CT No. 5367/2019 U/s 138 NI ACT, PS Model Town, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 23.09.2026.

By order

Sh. Aakash Sharma

Judicial Magistrate First Class-03

North, Room No. 213, 2nd Floor

Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/11748/NW/2026

SUMMER GETAWAY

From mountains to beaches, Bollywood celebs travel in style

Shahid Kapoor and Mira Rajput, meanwhile, explored the charm of Italy

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 21

Bollywood celebrities are taking a well-deserved break from their hectic shooting schedules, trading film sets for scenic mountains, pristine beaches and picturesque destinations. From Alia Bhatt and Ranbir Kapoor enjoying a leisurely boat ride with their daughter Raha to Sonakshi Sinha and Zaheer Iqbal soaking in the cultural richness of Bhutan, their 'Instagram' feeds are serving up some serious holiday inspiration.

Shahid Kapoor and Mira Rajput, meanwhile, explored the charm of Italy, while Kareena Kapoor Khan and Saif Ali Khan celebrated a special occasion in their signature globetrotting style.

Here's a look at the travel diaries of some of our favourite Bollywood stars.

Kareena Kapoor Khan and Saif Ali Khan

Kareena Kapoor Khan and Saif Ali Khan are no strangers to romantic getaways and family holidays.



This time, Kareena celebrated Saif's 56th birthday by sharing a series of candid and picture-perfect travel moments with her fans. The photographs captured the couple's love for exploring new destinations, along with their easygoing chemistry and fun moments together. "Happy Birthday to my forever ride or die... How boring would life be without you," Kareena wrote.

Alia Bhatt and Ranbir Kapoor

Bollywood stars don't always reveal their holiday destinations, but sometimes the pictures say it all. Alia Bhatt, Ranbir Kapoor and their daughter Raha recently offered fans a glimpse of a beautiful family getaway. The adorable trio was seen enjoying a scenic boat ride, with Raha sitting between her parents. Ranbir, sporting a cap, kept his arm stretched behind Alia as the family soaked in the picturesque surroundings.



Sonakshi Sinha and Zaheer Iqbal

Sonakshi Sinha and Zaheer Iqbal have certainly earned a reputation as one of Bollywood's most travel-loving couples. Since tying the knot, the couple has frequently shared glimpses of their adventures around the world. This summer, they headed to the majestic kingdom of Bhutan for a memorable family holiday.

From performing traditional dances and exploring dzongs, which are an integral part of Bhutan's cultural and administrative landscape, to enjoying hot stone baths and hiking to the iconic 'Taktshang' (Tiger's Nest) in Paro, Sonakshi and Zaheer embraced the country's culture and natural beauty to the fullest.

SONAKSHI SINHA AND ZAHEER IQBAL HAVE CERTAINLY EARNED A REPUTATION AS ONE OF BOLLYWOOD'S MOST TRAVEL-LOVING COUPLES

Mira Rajput and Shahid Kapoor

Shahid Kapoor appears to have developed quite a fondness for Italy. With his film 'Cocktail 2' adding to the connection, the actor's Italian holiday looked straight out of a movie. Shahid and his wife,



Mira Rajput, explored the country through leisurely boat rides, shopping trips and scenic outings. Mira shared glimpses of their beautiful getaway on 'Instagram', giving fans a peek into their relaxed holiday moments.

Kiara Advani and Sidharth Malhotra



One of Bollywood's most-loved couples, Kiara Advani and Sidharth Malhotra, recently enjoyed a Maldivian holiday with their daughter, Saraayah. The 'Toxic' actress shared several photographs from the getaway, offering fans a glimpse of the family's tropical escape as well as some adorable glimpses of their little one's holiday wardrobe.

FX'S 'LEGENDS'

Charlie Hunnam & 'Sons of Anarchy' cast reunite

The cast of hit outlaw biker drama 'Sons of Anarchy' is set to reunite for a new 'FX' limited series titled 'Legends', with Charlie Hunnam, Ron Perlman, Katey Sagal and other original stars returning.

Hunnam, who played biker gang leader Jax Teller in the original series, will be joined by Perlman as Clay, Sagal as Gemma, Maggie Siff as Tara, Mark Boone Junior as Bobby, Tommy Flanagan as Chibs, Kim Coates as Tig and Theo Rossi as Juice.

Unlike a conventional sequel, 'Legends' will blur the line between the actors' real lives and their iconic roles. The story follows the cast of 'Sons of Anarchy' as they reunite at a fan convention more than a decade after the original series ended, only to find themselves facing a real-world threat more dangerous than anything they encountered on the show.

Hunnam developed the series with Jonathan Groff and will serve as executive producer alongside Groff, Rob Mac, Nicholas Frenkel and Jackie Cohn. The series is produced by 'FX Productions' and '20th Television'.

"When Charlie brought us this inspired idea, we instantly sparked to his bold and entertaining vision," said Nick Grad, FX Entertainment's president.

Created by Kurt Sutter, 'Sons of Anarchy' premiered in 2008 and ran for seven seasons and nearly 100 episodes, following the lives of the members of an outlaw motorcycle club and their families in the fictional California town of Charming. The show's conclusion in 2014 marked the end of Hunnam's run as Jax, who became one of the actor's most recognisable roles.

Hunnam recently received his first Emmy nomination for his starring performance in Netflix's anthology series 'Monster: The Ed Gein Story'. PTI



HUNNAM PLAYED BIKER GANG LEADER JAX TELLER IN THE ORIGINAL SERIES

MAJOR BOX OFFICE MILESTONE

'The Odyssey' becomes highest-grossing R-rated movie of all time

Christopher Nolan's blockbuster hit 'The Odyssey' has crossed another major box office milestone by becoming the highest-grossing R-rated movie of all time with a collection of 1.352 billion dollars worldwide.

The movie, an adaptation of the famed Greek epic of the same name, surpassed 2024's 'Deadpool & Wolverine' with 1.338 billion dollars to claim the top spot, reported 'Variety'.

Nolan's mythological epic, the first movie ever to be shot entirely on IMAX cameras, was released in theatres on July 17, but it has continued to dominate the box office despite facing a challenge from another summer blockbuster in 'Spider-Man: Brand New Day'.

The big-budget adaptation of Homer's epic poem of almost 3,000 years old has generated



THE MOVIE, AN ADAPTATION OF THE FAMED GREEK EPIC OF THE SAME NAME, SURPASSED 2024'S 'DEADPOOL & WOLVERINE'

516 million dollars domestically and 835 million dollars internationally - a massive collection for any movie, but especially an R-rated drama set in the distant past. 'The Odyssey', which is also one of those rare movies to have sparked a cultural debate and a renewed interest in Greek mythology, is the only third R-rated movie after 'Deadpool & Wolverine' and 'Joker' to cross one billion dollars in revenue.

"The Odyssey" is also the biggest hit of Christopher Nolan's career. PTI

Charles Melton to feature in 'Naruto' film

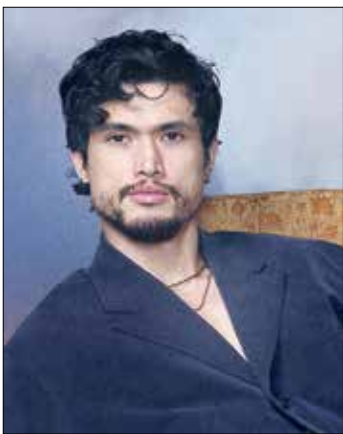
The actor is in talks to essay Kakashi Hatake in Lionsgate's film

Charles Melton is in talks to essay Kakashi Hatake in Lionsgate's 'Naruto' film. Hatake is the character from the Naruto anime and manga series created by Masashi Kishimoto. He is also known as the 'Copy Ninja' and 'Kakashi of the Sharingan'.

The upcoming live-action film adaptation is directed by Destin Daniel Cretton and also has Kishimoto on board, according to the entertainment news outlet 'Variety'.

The manga and anime follow adolescent ninja Naruto, who wants to turn into the protector and the leader of his community and is known as the village ninja. The 'Naruto' franchise includes 11 anime films released between 2004 and 2015, spanning both the original series and 'Naruto Shippuden'.

Melton is known for featuring as Reggie Mantle in the television series 'Riverdale', which



THE UPCOMING LIVE-ACTION FILM ADAPTATION IS DIRECTED BY DESTIN DANIEL CRETTON

started in 2017 and concluded in 2023. He last featured in 'Warfare'. It was released in 2025. PTI

Taapsee Pannu's 'Gandhari' to release on September 3

The 'Netflix' film is directed by Devashish Makhija and is produced by Kanika Dhillon

'Gandhari', featuring Taapsee Pannu, is set to release on 'Netflix' on September 3.

The film is directed by Devashish Makhija and is produced by Kanika Dhillon. It also features Ishwak Singh, Chhaya Kadam, Swastika Mukherjee, Mita Vashisht and Jatinder Sarna, according to a press release. It is set against the atmospheric backdrop of a fictitious town, Joypurra and follows a story of unwavering belief, quiet resilience and unflinching courage. At its heart lies Bani, a mother whose devotion is tested at every turn, compelling her to confront challenges.

The film also reunites 'Netflix' with Dhillon and Pannu following their collaboration on 'Phir Aayi Hasseen Dill-ruba'. Dhillon said the film is a story of a 'woman who refused to be defined by her circumstances'.



"Bani's journey is raw, relentless and deeply personal and that is what drew me to her from the very beginning. Reuniting with Taapsee once again has been incredibly special - there is a deep creative trust and understanding that we have built over the years and watching her bring Bani to life with

IT ALSO FEATURES ISHWAK SINGH, CHHAYA KADAM, SWASTIKA MUKHERJEE, MITA VASHISHT AND JATIN SARNA

such commitment and intensity was truly rewarding," she said. Ruchika Kapoor Sheikh, Director of 'Original Films', 'Netflix India', said, "'Gandhari' is a bold, emotionally charged action thriller that turns a mother's love into a force - fierce, instinctive and impossible to ignore."

"We are delighted to reunite with Pannu and Kanika Dhillon, building on a creative partnership we deeply value and carrying it into a strikingly different space with Devashish Makhija at the helm," she added.

It is produced under 'Kathha Pictures'. PTI

